

COMPLETE TOPIC PACKAGE

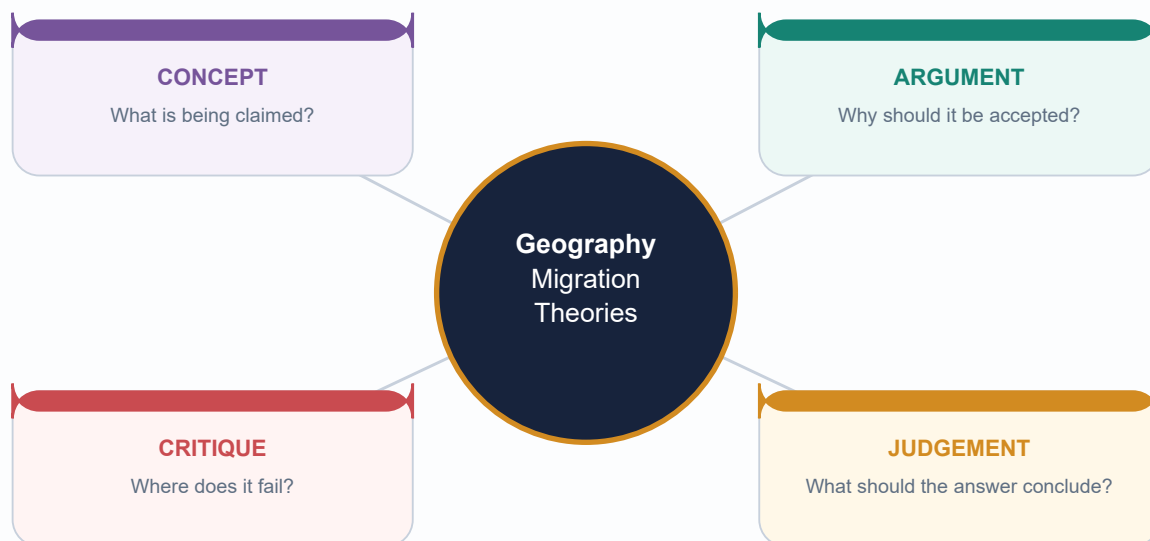
Geography 27 - Migration Theories and Patterns in India

Complete visual-first learning session and solved practice

Export date and evidence cutoff: 19 August 2026

Status: Generated for review - NOT APPROVED

Final consolidated register notes are placed last



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Evidence, terminology, source and visual register

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- **Complete Topic Package + Solved Practice Edition**

- **Export date / evidence retrieval date:** 19 August 2026

- **Status:** Generated for review; **NOT APPROVED**.

- **## Evidence and terminology protocol**

- This package uses evidence in the required order: authored repository Markdown, OCR-searchable local books and official PYQ scans, live primary sources, then optional Qdrant. Qdrant was not required. Every volatile figure is date-bound and classified as a census stock, survey estimate, administrative registration, transaction count, flow, model estimate or projection.

- **Census stock is not a current flow.** Census 2011 remains the latest completed decennial migration baseline available here.

- **Census 2027 status is not a result.** Phase II is scheduled to collect migration information, but no final Census 2027 migration table exists at this cutoff.

- **A survey rate is not a headcount.** MoSPI explicitly cautions that design-based estimated migrant totals in its appendix are control totals, not intended estimates of the number of migrants.

- **Registration is not migration.** e-Shram registration records a covered administrative population; it neither proves movement nor measures welfare use or outcomes.

- **Portability availability is not utilisation or impact.** ONORC coverage, transactions and foodgrain delivery are separate indicators.

- **Diaspora, migrant stock and departures are different.** MEA's Overseas Indians table combines PIOs and NRIs; UN DESA's international migrant stock follows demographic concepts; eMigrate records only covered administrative processes.

- **Refugee is a legal category.** Migrant, refugee, asylum-seeker, internally displaced person and stateless person are never used interchangeably.

- **Missing objective-key protocol:** INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, confidence level and elimination logic. No included objective PYQ requires this label because the 2024 Set-A key is locally available.

- **## Source register**

- Institution | Source | Primary URL | Use and boundary

- MoSPI / NSO | *Migration in India 2020-21*, PLFS framework |

https://mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/publication_reports/Migration%20in%20India%20RL16082023.pdf | Survey migration rate, last usual residence, reasons, temporary visitors; July 2020-June 2021

- Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India | Census 2011 D-03, place of last residence |

<https://censusindia.gov.in/nada/index.php/catalog/10840> | All-duration stock, duration and reason; dated 2011 baseline

- PIB / RGI | Census 2027 schedule and design, 30 March 2026 | <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2246847> | STATUS only; Phase II will collect migration; no result yet

- MoSPI / NSO | PLFS Monthly Bulletin, July 2026, released 17 August 2026 | https://mospi.gov.in/uploads/latestReleases/latest_release_1786961114962_47b9343c-f726-4581-8440-c2f119a86ab6_Monthly_Press_note_July_2026.pdf | Current labour-market context, not a migration measure

- Ministry of Labour and Employment / PIB | e-Shram status, 2 February 2026 | <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2222263> | 31.48 crore registrations as on 26 January 2026; registration, not migrant count
- Ministry of Labour and Employment / PIB | Labour Codes status, 30 December 2025 and 5 February 2026 | <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2209767> ; <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2223852> | Codes effective 21 November 2025; expanded inter-State migrant-worker provisions
- Department of Food and Public Distribution / PIB | Year End Review 2024: ONORC | <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2086345> | Nationwide architecture and dated transaction totals; not a 2026 outcome estimate
- RBI | *Changing Dynamics of India's Remittances*, sixth-round survey, 2023-24 | https://www.rbi.org.in/scripts/BS_ViewBulletin.aspx?Id=23260 | Definition, channels, source countries, costs and survey coverage
- World Bank | Personal remittances received, India, indicator BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT | <https://api.worldbank.org/v2/country/IND/indicator/BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT?format=json> | Annual current-US-dollar series; definition differs from RBI survey
- MEA | Population of Overseas Indians, January 2026 | <https://www.mea.gov.in/population-of-overseas-indians> | PIO + NRI administrative compilation; not UN migrant stock or annual flow
- MEA | Emigration Service and intending-emigrant guidance | <https://www.mea.gov.in/emigration-service> ; <https://www.mea.gov.in/issues-of-intending-emigrants> | eMigrate, recruiting agents, ECR governance and worker protection
- UN DESA Population Division | International Migrant Stock 2024 | <https://www.un.org/development/desa/pd/content/international-migrant-stock> | Demographic stock by origin/destination/sex for 1990-2024
- IOM | World Migration Report 2026 release, 5 May 2026 | <https://www.iom.int/news/iom-report-migration-drives-economies-and-development-gains-are-risk> | Global estimate and policy status; modelled international stock
- IOM | Glossary on Migration | <https://publications.iom.int/books/international-migration-law-ndeg34-glossary-migration> | Generic migration, mobility and diaspora terminology
- UNHCR | Refugees, asylum-seekers, IDPs, figures at a glance | <https://www.unhcr.org/about-unhcr/who-we-protect/refugees> ; <https://www.unhcr.org/about-unhcr/who-we-protect/asylum-seekers> ; <https://www.unhcr.org/about-unhcr/who-we-protect/internally-displaced-people> | Legal-category firewall and end-2025 status
- UNHCR | Climate change and displacement: myths and facts | <https://www.unhcr.org/news/stories/climate-change-and-displacement-myths-and-facts> | "Climate refugee" is not a recognised legal term
- ILO | STREAM: South Asia-Gulf social protection programme | <https://www.ilo.org/projects-and-partnerships/projects/stream-extending-social-protection-migrant-workers-and-their-families-south> | Portability, gender and rights in a major labour corridor
- UNFCCC WIM Task Force on Displacement | Human mobility workstream | <https://unfccc.int/process/bodies/constituted-bodies/WIMExCom/TFD> | Migration, displacement and planned relocation in climate planning
- NDMA | SACHET national disaster-alert portal | <https://sachet.ndma.gov.in/> | Warning and evacuation context; no national 2026 climate-migrant count inferred
- **Retrieval date for all live sources:** 19 August 2026.
- Local authored, book and PYQ evidence

- Core owner: upsc-ai-kit/knowledge/Geography/basic/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India.md.
- Advanced owner: upsc-ai-kit/knowledge/Geography/advanced/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India.md.
- Linked Geography owners: topic 26 population and DTM; 28 settlements and urbanisation; 29 regional development; 30 agriculture; 32 industries; 33 transport and trade; 36 contemporary issues; 37 cultural and social geography.
- Linked interdisciplinary owners: Economy employment/labour codes and balance of payments; Indian Society population, rural society, women, urbanisation and globalisation; Social Justice labour and migrant workers, women, food security and welfare data; Disaster Management inclusive protection and climate risk; International Relations diaspora and consular protection.
- OCR-searchable book evidence: Majid Husain, *Indian & World Geography*, PDF p. 333 on push-pull, internal/international movement and the refugee-emigrant distinction. Source-era statements are treated as conceptual, not current.
- The local D.R. Khullar and shorter Majid India scans did not yield reliable searchable text for this chapter. Their authored owner summaries were used, but no unsearchable page was reconstructed.
- Local official scans verify: 2018 GS-I Q13; 2020 GS-II Q10; 2023 GS-II Q10; 2024 GS-I Q5 and Q19; 2024 Prelims GS-I Set-A Q75 and official key C.
- ## Visual register - 28 original PNGs
- 1. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/01_mobility-taxonomy.png
- 2. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/02_measurement-data-firewall.png
- 3. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/03_migration-formulas.png
- 4. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/04_data-source-ladder.png
- 5. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/05_spatial-classification-matrix.png
- 6. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/06_ravenstein-historical-laws.png
- 7. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/07_lee-push-pull-obstacles.png
- 8. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/08_spatial-interaction-models.png
- 9. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/09_harris-todaro-expected-income.png
- 10. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/10_lewis-dual-sector.png
- 11. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/11_nelm-household-portfolio.png
- 12. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/12_structural-network-theories.png
- 13. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/13_zelinsky-mobility-transition.png
- 14. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/14_migration-selectivity-wheel.png
- 15. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/15_india-evidence-dashboard.png
- 16. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/16_india-corridor-network-map.png
- 17. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/17_india-streams-matrix.png
- 18. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/18_gendered-migration-lens.png
- 19. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/19_origin-destination-balance.png
- 20. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/20_urban-growth-three-drivers.png

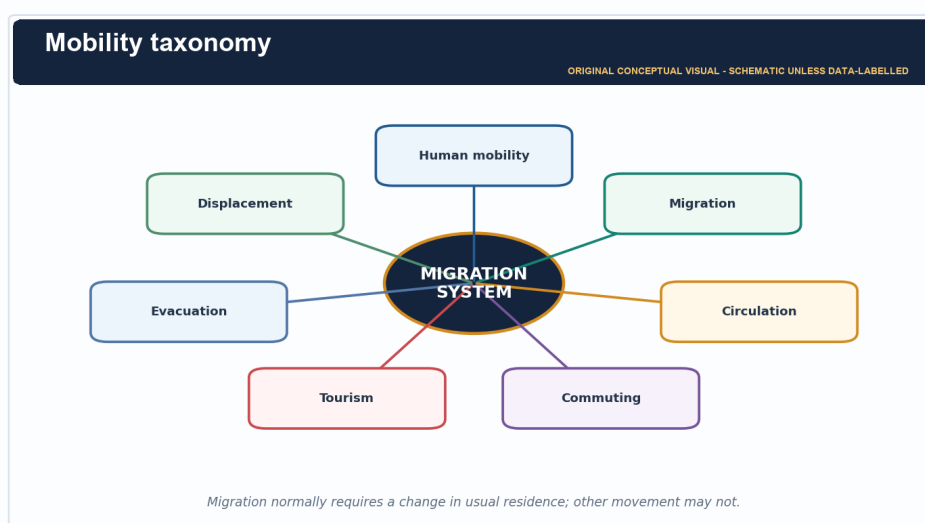
- 21. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/21_remittance-definition-channels.png
- 22. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/22_international-category-firewall.png
- 23. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/23_forced-displacement-legal-tree.png
- 24. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/24_climate-mobility-spectrum.png
- 25. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/25_governance-portability-ladder.png
- 26. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/26_policy-architecture.png
- 27. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/27_monitoring-dashboard.png
- 28. notes/Geography/assets/27_Migration-Theories-and-Patterns-India/28_upsc-answer-spine.png

MAINS ANGLE

Every volatile statement is date-bound and classified as stock, flow, survey estimate, registration, transaction, model estimate, projection or legal status.

STUDY LINK

Primary-source register retrieved 19 August 2026; local authored owners, OCR books and official PYQ scans are documented.

HIGH**1. Roadmap: from movement to migration system**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**ROADMAP: FROM MOVEMENT TO MIGRATION SYSTEM**

The roadmap begins by separating everyday mobility from a change in usual residence, then moves from measurement to theory, pattern, consequence and policy.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Migration is not a synonym for every movement. A complete answer moves through six gates:
- 1. **Define the movement:** migration, circulation, commuting, evacuation or displacement.
- 2. **Define the evidence:** census stock, survey estimate, administrative registration, flow or projection.
- 3. **Classify the geography:** origin, destination, distance, boundary, duration and direction.
- 4. **Choose the explanatory scale:** individual, household, labour market, network, region or world system.
- 5. **Trace differentiated effects:** migrant, household, source, destination and wider economy.
- 6. **End with rights and governance:** portability, safe recruitment, housing, services, data and coordination.

- The central thesis is that migration is a **spatial reallocation of people, labour, care, risk and social ties**. It can be opportunity-seeking and distress-driven at the same time. It can raise household income while transferring social-reproduction costs to families left behind. It can support city productivity while exposing workers to informality and exclusion. Restricting mobility does not correct the underlying spatial concentration of opportunity.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

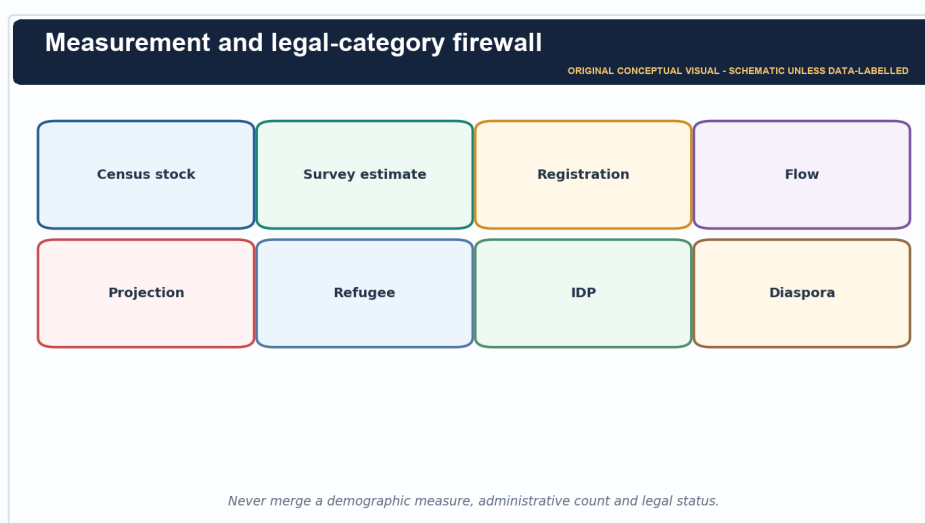
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

2. Vocabulary and legal-category firewall

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

VOCABULARY AND LEGAL-CATEGORY FIREWALL



The firewall prevents analytical categories from being merged merely because they involve movement.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Term | Exam-safe meaning | Boundary or trap
- Human mobility | Umbrella term for movement of persons | Includes migration, commuting, tourism, nomadism, evacuation and displacement
- Migration | Movement away from usual residence, internally or internationally | Dataset-specific residence and duration rules still matter
- Circulation | Repeated or periodic movement with continuing links to more than one place | May not create a permanent residence change
- Circular migration | Repeat movement between origin and destination, often for work | One round is a flow; people present at a date are a stock
- Commuting | Frequent travel between home and work/study without changing usual residence | Usually not migration
- Tourism | Temporary travel outside usual environment without a residence shift for migration measurement | Tourism statistics follow their own duration and purpose rules
- Evacuation | Organised movement from immediate danger to safety | Can be temporary; not automatically displacement of long duration

- Displacement | Involuntary or coerced movement from home or habitual residence | Cause and border-crossing determine the relevant category
- Refugee | Person outside their country who meets the applicable international protection definition | Not interchangeable with migrant or every disaster-displaced person
- Asylum-seeker | Person seeking international protection whose claim is pending or intended | Not every asylum-seeker is recognised as a refugee
- Internally displaced person | Person forced to flee but remaining within their country | Has not crossed an international border
- Stateless person | Person not considered a national by any State under the operation of its law | Statelessness is a nationality status, not automatically migration
- Migrant worker | Person moving for remunerated work; legal definitions vary by instrument and internal/international context | Do not reduce all migrants to workers
- Diaspora | Migrants and descendants whose identity and links are shaped by migration experience | Broader than current international migrant stock
- **Key distinction:** forced and voluntary are not a clean binary. A household may choose who moves, yet choose under debt, drought, violence or livelihood collapse. Agency exists on a constrained field.
- **Legal caution for India:** do not infer that one global label automatically produces one domestic legal status. State practice, domestic law, constitutional rights, sectoral statutes and international obligations must be identified separately.

MAINS ANGLE

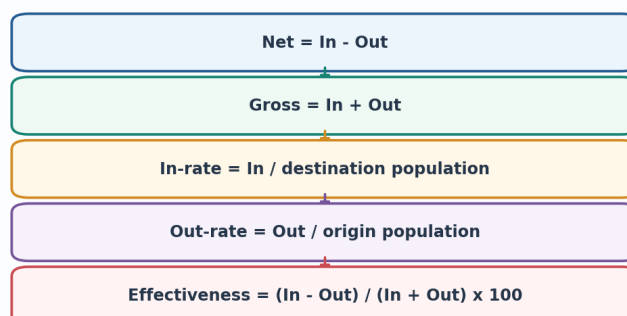
Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**3. How migration is measured**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**HOW MIGRATION IS MEASURED****Migration formula board**

ORIGINAL CONCEPTUAL VISUAL - SCHEMATIC UNLESS DATA-LABELLED



Zero net migration can conceal large two-way turnover.

Every migration statistic requires a numerator, denominator, boundary and time window.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Measure | Logic | Main limitation
- Place of birth | Current residence differs from birthplace | Misses subsequent moves and return to birthplace
- Place of last residence | Current residence differs from previous usual residence | Misses intermediate moves and some circulation
- Duration at destination | Time since last move | Recall and interval categories affect precision
- Reason for migration | Respondent's recorded primary reason | One reason can conceal work, care or household strategy
- Usual residence | Place meeting a stated duration or intention threshold | Short seasonal moves can disappear below threshold
- Migrant stock | Migrants present in a territory at a point/date | Does not count all movements during the interval
- Migration flow | Moves, entries or exits during a specified interval | Repeat movers may be counted more than once
- In-migration | Moves into the defined area | Requires a boundary and time period
- Out-migration | Moves out of the defined area | Origin denominator differs from destination denominator
- Gross migration | In-migration plus out-migration | Measures turnover, not net redistribution
- Net migration | In-migration minus out-migration | A zero net value can hide very large two-way flows
- Net migration rate | Net migration divided by a stated population, multiplied by k | Denominator convention must be declared
- Lifetime migrant | Residence differs from birthplace, or an all-duration concept explicitly defined by source | Not necessarily a single move
- Recent migrant | Move occurred within a stated recent interval, such as 0-4 years | Sensitive to interval and recall
- Migration effectiveness | Signed or absolute net migration divided by gross migration, multiplied by 100 | Convention must be stated; high value means stronger redistribution
- Formula set
- Net migration = In-migrants - Out-migrants.
- Gross migration = In-migrants + Out-migrants.
- In-migration rate = In-migrants during interval / destination population at risk x 1,000.
- Out-migration rate = Out-migrants during interval / origin population at risk x 1,000.
- Net migration rate = Net migration / stated mid-period or average population x 1,000.
- Migration effectiveness ratio = $(In - Out) / (In + Out) \times 100$; use the absolute value only if measuring strength rather than direction.
- **Denominator discipline:** the MoSPI 2020-21 "migration rate" is the percentage of migrants in the population under its last-usual-residence definition. It is not an annual migration-event rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

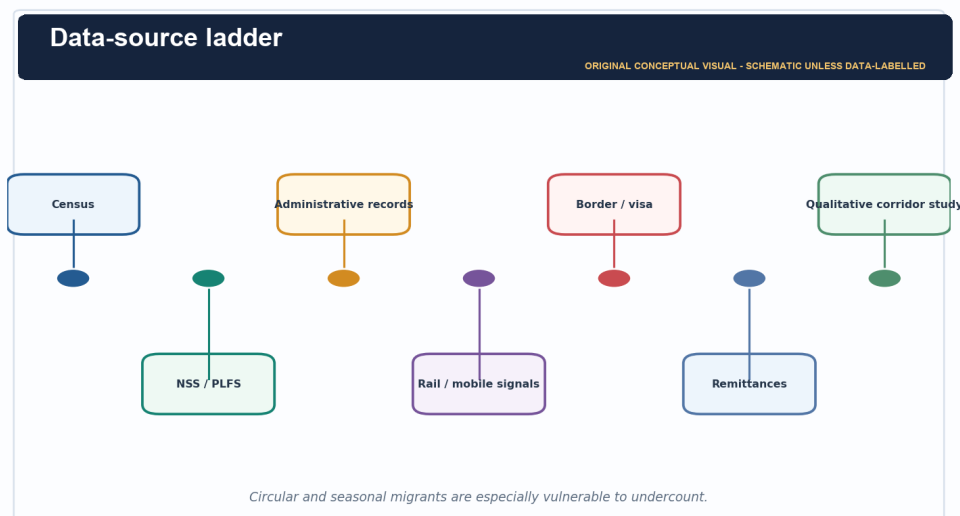
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

4. Data-source ladder and the undercount problem

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

DATA-SOURCE LADDER AND THE UNDERCOUNT PROBLEM



No single instrument captures residence stock, repeated mobility, legal status, labour outcome and remittances simultaneously.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Source | Strength | Coverage and comparability limit
- Census | Near-universal small-area stock, origin-destination and duration tables | Infrequent; usual-residence rules miss some seasonal/circular movement
- NSS/PLFS survey | Reasons, sex, residence and labour context with known design | Sampling and recall error; survey definitions differ from census
- Administrative records | Timely operational data for covered schemes or legal processes | Excludes non-users and uncovered persons; registration is not outcome
- e-Shram | Large database of self-declared unorganised workers and scheme integration | Not a migration register; duplicates, updating and category use require metadata
- Railway/ticket data | High-frequency movement signals | Ticketing, repeat journeys and motive are incomplete
- Mobile-phone data | Fine temporal and spatial mobility patterns | Device ownership, SIM behaviour, privacy and representativeness
- Border/visa/eMigrate | International entries, visas or covered emigration processes | Different universes; ECR clearance does not equal all departures
- Remittance data | Financial link between migrant and recipient economy/household | Sender identity, purpose, informal channels and definitions vary
- Qualitative corridor studies | Recruitment chains, occupations, agency and vulnerability | Not nationally representative
- Circular migration is undercount-prone because the worker may remain a usual resident of the origin, be absent during enumeration, move through multiple worksites or stay for less than the threshold. Women may be recorded as marriage migrants even while undertaking substantial paid and unpaid economic work. Street-based and homeless workers may fall outside household frames. A crisis survey can capture exceptional movement but should not be frozen into a permanent pattern.
- **Big-data rule:** use railway or mobile data to estimate movement intensity and timing, not legal category, motive or welfare status unless independently validated.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**5. Spatial and temporal classifications****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**SPATIAL AND TEMPORAL CLASSIFICATIONS**

Migration has simultaneous classifications by boundary, direction, duration, sequence and degree of compulsion.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Dimension | Categories | Example of analytical use
- National boundary | Internal / international | Different law, currency, border and data systems
- Administrative distance | Intra-district / inter-district / inter-State | Separates local marriage movement from long-distance labour corridors
- Settlement direction | Rural-rural / rural-urban / urban-urban / urban-rural | Connects migration to urbanisation and settlement hierarchy
- Sequence | Direct / step / chain | Village-small town-metropolis versus network-assisted direct move
- Repetition | One-time / repeat / circular / seasonal | Welfare portability and employer responsibility
- Return | Planned / retirement / opportunity-driven / crisis-driven | Reintegration and local labour absorption differ
- Household pattern | Individual pioneer / tied mover / split household / family reunion | Shows who decides and who bears care work
- Production system | Transhumant / agricultural seasonal / industrial-contract / service-professional | Links ecology and labour demand
- Degree of compulsion | Opportunity-led / constrained / forced | Avoids a false voluntary-forced binary
- Displacement cause | Conflict/persecution / disaster / development project / conservation / urban project | Legal and rehabilitation routes differ

- **Step migration** describes sequential movement through settlement levels. **Chain migration** describes later movers following social links established by earlier movers. **Return migration** is movement back to an earlier origin; **reverse migration** usually denotes movement contrary to the dominant direction, often during a shock. **Transhumance** is seasonal movement of people and livestock between customary pastures and should not be collapsed into urban labour migration.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

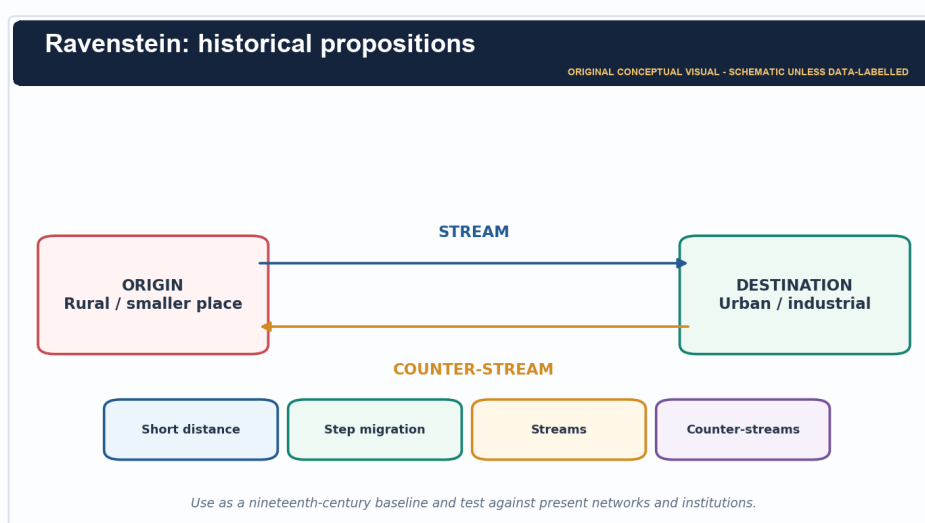
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

6. Ravenstein's laws: historical propositions, not universal laws

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

RAVENSTEIN'S LAWS: HISTORICAL PROPOSITIONS, NOT UNIVERSAL LAWS



Ravenstein's nineteenth-century generalisations remain hypotheses about distance, direction and selectivity, not timeless laws.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Ravenstein used British census material in the 1880s to propose recurring regularities:
- most migrants move relatively short distances;
- long-distance movers tend toward major centres of commerce and industry;
- migration can proceed by stages;
- each major stream tends to generate a counter-stream;
- rural populations show greater propensity to move than urban populations in the historical setting;
- economic motives were treated as dominant;
- women were described as more migratory over short internal distances, while men predominated in longer and international moves.
- Why it remains useful
- Distance decay, step movement, counter-streams and urban-industrial attraction still organise many spatial patterns. India's high share of same-State movement and the persistence of return flows fit parts of the framework.

- Why it must be qualified

- The propositions emerged from one nineteenth-century national setting. Transport, digital information, borders, recruitment systems, marriage rules, education, conflict and state policy have changed the cost surface. The gender proposition is context-dependent and can be reversed by marriage systems, domestic work, care migration or professional mobility. Circular movement does not fit a permanent one-way model. Ravenstein should open an argument, not close it.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

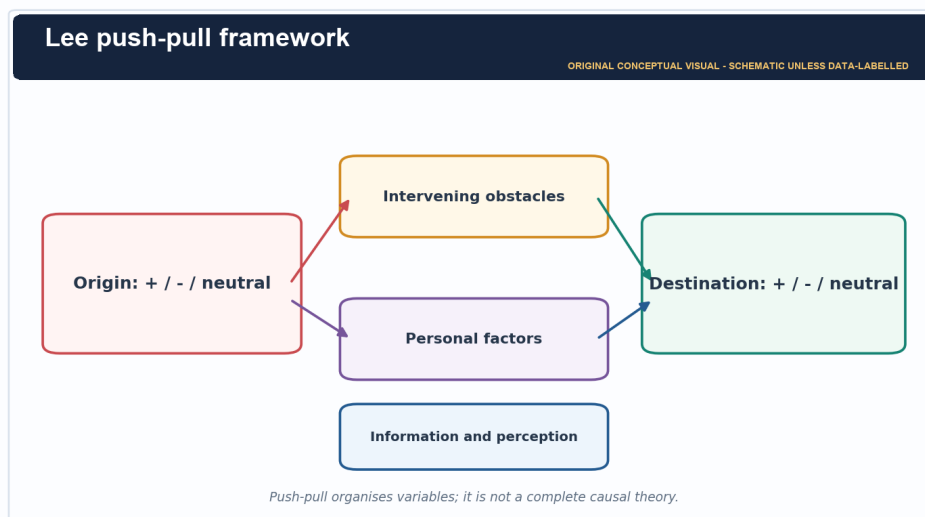
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

7. Lee's push-pull model

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

LEE'S PUSH-PULL MODEL



Lee adds perception, intervening obstacles and personal factors to the origin-destination comparison.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Lee's framework contains:

- 1. factors associated with the origin;
- 2. factors associated with the destination;
- 3. intervening obstacles;
- 4. personal factors and selectivity.

- The same factor is not universally positive or negative. High urban wages may attract a skilled worker but be offset by rent and care costs for another household. Drought can push a landless labourer but be absorbed by irrigation, savings or public employment for a better-protected household. Information is filtered through networks and expectations.

- **Intervening obstacles** include distance, travel cost, border rules, language, recruitment fees, discrimination, documentation, housing, childcare and risk. **Personal factors** include age, education, caste/class position, gender norms, marital status, household role, health and risk tolerance.

- Strength

- The model is an excellent checklist and diagram. It explains why identical wage gaps produce different migration outcomes.
- Limit
- Push-pull categories can become a descriptive list rather than a causal theory. They do not specify how factors are weighted, how households bargain, why employers create demand, or why one corridor becomes self-reinforcing. Combine Lee with expected-income, household, structural and network theories.

MAINS ANGLE

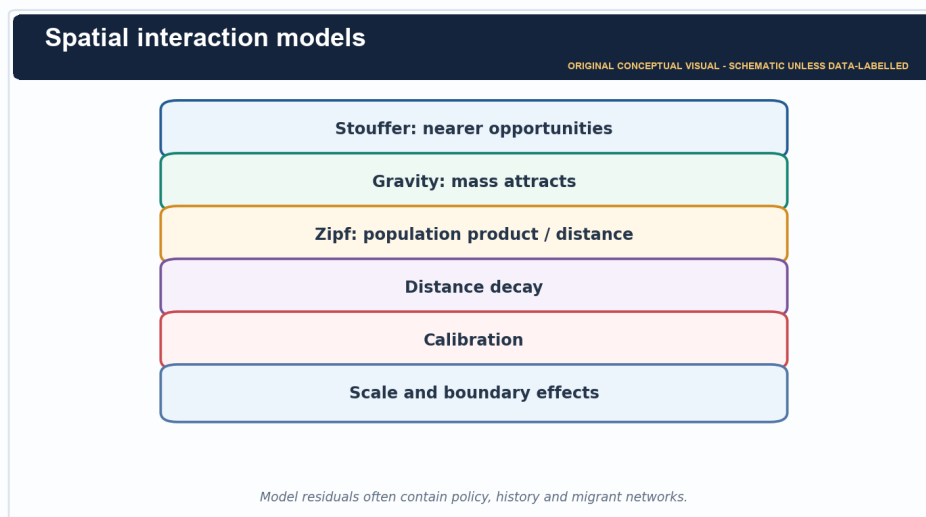
Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**8. Stouffer, Zipf, gravity and distance decay**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STOUFFER, ZIPF, GRAVITY AND DISTANCE DECAY

Spatial-interaction models estimate potential flow, while opportunity and network theories explain why actual routes depart from simple distance.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Stouffer's intervening opportunities
- Migration between origin and destination depends less on kilometres alone than on the number of acceptable opportunities at the destination relative to opportunities encountered before reaching it. A nearer expanding regional city can intercept a flow that might otherwise reach a metropolis.
- Gravity model
- At UPSC depth:
 - $M_{ij} = K (P_i \times P_j) / d_{ij}^b$
 - where M_{ij} is expected interaction, P_i and P_j represent population or opportunity mass, d_{ij} is distance or generalised cost, b is a calibrated distance-friction parameter and K is a scaling constant.
 - **Distance decay** means interaction generally falls as distance or cost rises. Real distance is not just kilometres: time, fare, border control, language, risk and information matter.

- Calibration and scale limits
- The exponent and opportunity measure must be estimated for the relevant region and period.
- Large populations can produce high predicted flows even where policy blocks movement.
- Aggregate models can hide caste, gender, occupation and household selectivity.
- Administrative boundaries create modifiable-area effects.
- Networks can reduce social distance even when physical distance is large.
- Use gravity as a baseline expectation, then explain residuals with history, policy, labour demand and networks.

MAINS ANGLE

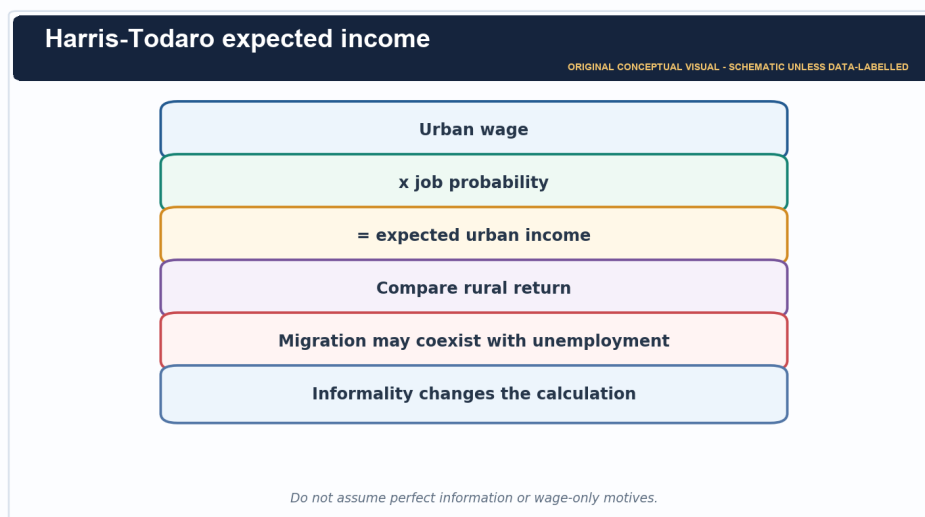
Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**9. Harris-Todaro expected-income model**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

HARRIS-TODARO EXPECTED-INCOME MODEL

Migration can continue despite urban unemployment when expected, not observed, urban income exceeds the rural alternative.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Simplified logic:
- Expected urban income = probability of obtaining urban employment x urban formal wage
- A prospective migrant compares expected urban income, informal-sector fallback and migration costs with expected rural income. The model explains why a visible urban unemployed or informal population does not automatically stop rural-urban migration.
- India application
- Large cities offer diversified entry points in construction, transport, retail, domestic work, manufacturing and services. Networks raise the probability of finding some work. The relevant comparison is therefore not a single factory wage against a farm wage.

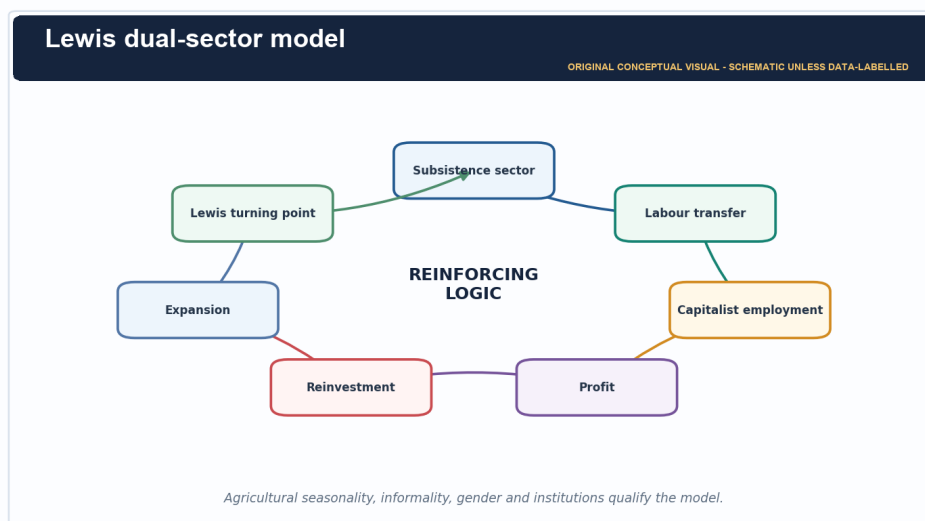
- Policy implications
- Urban job creation alone can attract additional migrants if the expected-income gap widens.
- Rural productivity, non-farm employment and intermediate-town opportunities can reduce distress without restricting movement.
- Housing, transport and job matching alter the effective expected return.
- Limits
- Migrants do not possess perfect information. Wages are not the only motive. Informality is not merely a waiting room for formal jobs. Households may value risk diversification, education, safety, marriage, autonomy or networks. The probability of employment is endogenous to discrimination, skills and contacts.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**10. Lewis dual-sector model**
GS-I / GS-II
 Geography
LEWIS DUAL-SECTOR MODEL

Lewis links labour transfer to structural transformation, capital accumulation and an eventual turning point.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- The model begins with a traditional subsistence sector containing labour whose marginal product is assumed low, and a capitalist sector offering a wage premium. Profits are reinvested, labour demand expands and workers transfer from agriculture to modern production. At the **Lewis turning point**, surplus labour is exhausted and real wages rise more broadly.
- Analytical value
- It connects migration with sectoral change rather than treating movement as an isolated demographic event. It asks whether industry and modern services productively absorb labour.
- India qualifications
- Agriculture has seasonal peaks; labour labelled "surplus" may be essential at sowing or harvest.

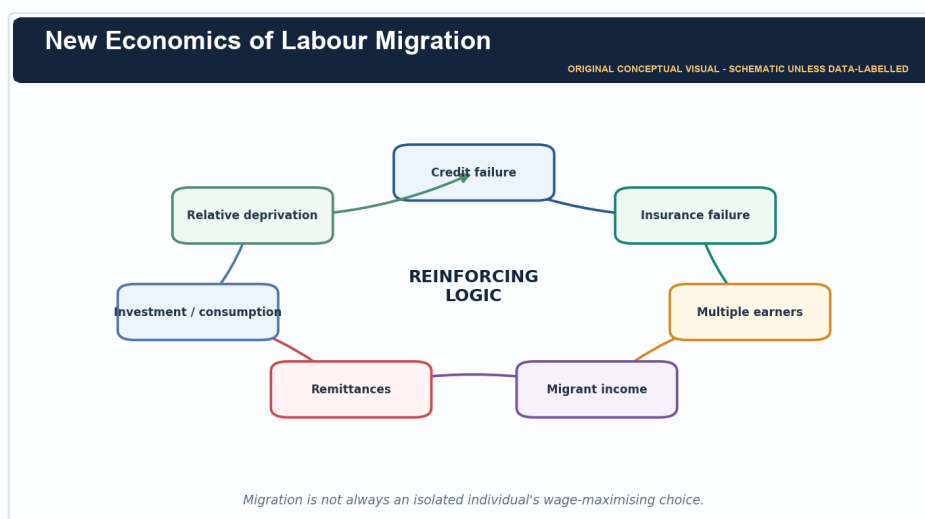
- The urban informal sector can expand without the productivity and wage gains assumed in a binary model.
- Women may be excluded from counted labour despite large productive and care contributions.
- Caste, land relations, tenancy, education and recruitment institutions affect who can move.
- Capital-intensive growth can weaken labour absorption.
- A turning point can vary by region, skill and gender rather than occur once nationally.
- Structural transformation is successful only when movement is accompanied by rising productivity, secure work, housing and capabilities.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**11. New Economics of Labour Migration****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**NEW ECONOMICS OF LABOUR MIGRATION**

The household may send a migrant to diversify income, overcome missing insurance and finance investment.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- NELM shifts the decision unit from an isolated individual to the household. Migration can:
- diversify exposure to crop, price and local employment risk;
- substitute for absent credit and insurance markets;
- finance education, housing, health, debt repayment or enterprise;
- improve a household's position relative to a reference group;
- allocate members across places while maintaining a split household.
- Remittances are therefore part of an implicit household contract, not simply money sent by an atomised worker.
- Strength

- The theory explains migration even when the migrant's own short-term wage gain is modest. It also explains why families retain land and keep return options open.
- Limits
- Households are not unitary. Gender, generation and control over remittances matter. Risk can be transferred to the migrant. The poorest may be unable to finance movement. Remittances may support consumption without generating local productive transformation.

MAINS ANGLE

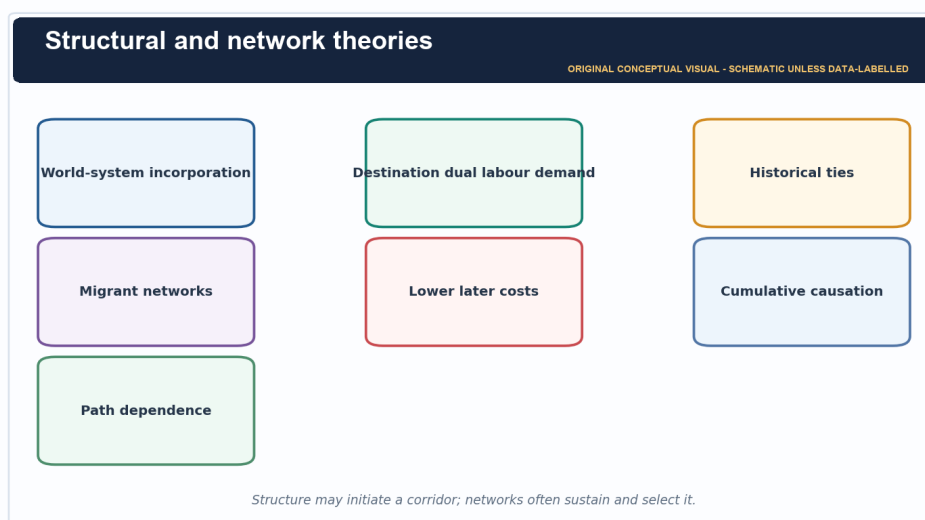
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STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**12. Structural, labour-market and network theories**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STRUCTURAL, LABOUR-MARKET AND NETWORK THEORIES

Theories operate at different levels: global structure, destination demand, household strategy and corridor reproduction.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Theory | Explanation level | Core claim | Main limitation
- World-systems | Historical-global | Capitalist expansion, colonial ties and uneven incorporation create migration links | Can understate agency and proximate motives
- Dual labour market | Destination economy | Advanced economies generate structural demand for low-status, insecure jobs | Better for international destination demand than all internal flows
- Network theory | Social corridor | Earlier migrants reduce later movers' information, housing and job costs | Explains continuation better than initiation
- Cumulative causation | Dynamic system | Each move changes networks, expectations, land/labour markets and culture, making more migration likely | Path dependence is not irreversible
- Segmented labour market | Institutional destination | Workers are sorted into protected and precarious segments | Segments vary and workers can move between them

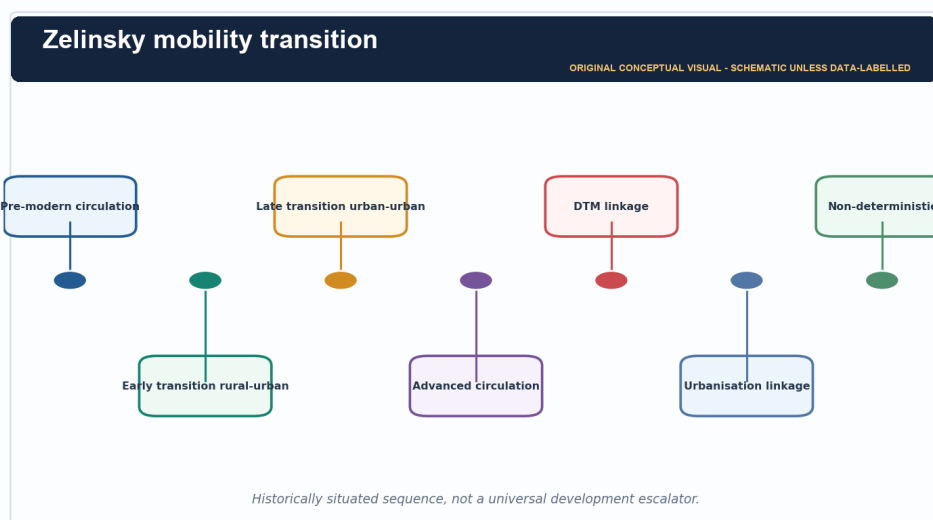
- Historical-institutional | State and corridor | Borders, recruitment rules, transport and past ties channel movement | Requires case-specific evidence
- Social capital and path dependence
- Networks can provide trust, loans, accommodation and job referral. They can also enforce dependence, occupational clustering and recruiter power. Once a corridor forms, it may persist after the original wage differential changes. This is cumulative causation: migration changes the conditions that produce later migration.
- Explanation-level rule
- Do not make theories compete when they answer different questions. World-systems explains why an unequal corridor exists; dual labour market explains destination demand; NELM explains household participation; networks explain route persistence; Lee explains perceived obstacles.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**13. Zelinsky's mobility transition**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**ZELINSKY'S MOBILITY TRANSITION**

Zelinsky links dominant forms of mobility with demographic and urban transitions, but the sequence is historically situated and non-deterministic.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- The mobility-transition hypothesis associates:
 - pre-modern settings with limited permanent migration but local circulation;
 - early transition with rural colonisation, frontier movement and rapid rural-urban migration;
 - later transition with inter-urban mobility, suburbanisation and reduced rural exodus;
 - advanced systems with high circulation, commuting and complex international mobility.
- It is useful because the demographic transition model excludes migration from its core birth-death mechanism. Zelinsky restores movement to the development story.

- Limits

- The sequence was generalised from particular Western experiences. Colonial labour systems, forced displacement, welfare regimes, global care chains, digital work, restrictive borders and climate risk can produce different paths. India contains multiple transition stages simultaneously: agrarian seasonal migration, metropolitan professional circulation, peri-urban commuting and international contract labour coexist.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

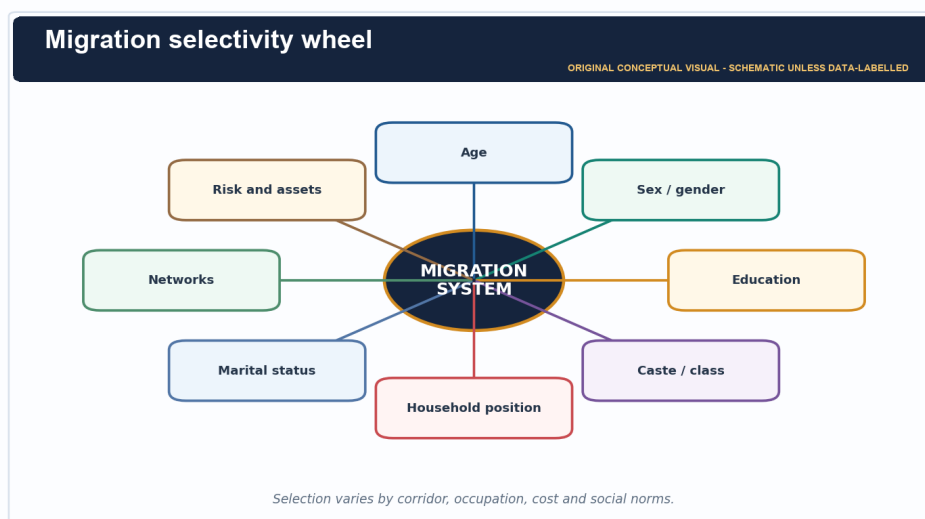
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

14. Migration selectivity

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

MIGRATION SELECTIVITY



Selection affects who moves, who stays, the corridor used and the consequences at both ends.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Dimension | Possible mechanism | Anti-stereotype qualification

- Age | Young adults often face lower moving costs and higher lifetime return | Children, elderly and families move in conflict, care and reunion streams

- Sex/gender | Marriage systems, labour demand, safety and care shape movement | Women are workers and agents, not merely tied movers

- Education | Skills expand destination set and information | Low-skilled migration also requires networks, finance and knowledge

- Caste/class | Assets and contacts finance movement; exclusion can also push | The poorest may be trapped and unable to migrate

- Household position | Pioneer, dependent, earner or caregiver roles differ | Decisions are negotiated and can be coercive

- Marital status | Marriage and family formation alter mobility | Recorded marriage reason can conceal economic contribution

- Risk tolerance | Expected gain is weighed against uncertainty | Risk is socially distributed, not just individual psychology

- Networks | Lower cost and raise destination specificity | Networks can also reproduce exploitation

- Selectivity means migration can drain working-age or skilled people from an origin, change sex ratios, alter fertility and reshape political voice. But there is no single migrant profile across marriage, professional, refugee, student, pastoral and circular-labour streams.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

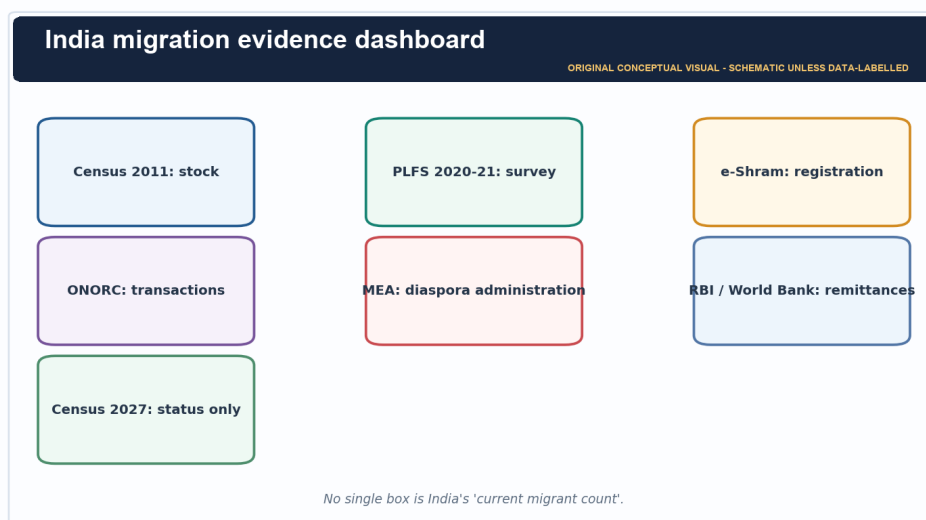
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

15. India evidence dashboard: keep instruments separate

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

INDIA EVIDENCE DASHBOARD: KEEP INSTRUMENTS SEPARATE



India's migration picture changes with the residence concept, survey period and administrative universe.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Label | Dated fact | Meaning | Limit

- CENSUS STOCK | Census 2011 D-03 recorded 455.8 million all-duration migrants by place of last residence | Broad stock under the 2011 census definition | Not a 2026 count

- CENSUS SHARE | About 37.6% of the 2011 population under that broad all-duration measure | Shows migration is not a marginal phenomenon | Includes marriage and local movement; not annual flow

- CENSUS INTERNAL | 449.9 million had last residence within India; about 87.9% of these were within the State of enumeration | Intra-State predominance | 2011 baseline

- SURVEY RATE | MoSPI PLFS 2020-21 migration rate: 28.9%; rural 26.5%; urban 34.9% | Percentage of population classified as migrant | July 2020-June 2021; different design

- SURVEY ORIGIN | PLFS migrants: 87.5% same State, 11.8% another State, 0.7% other country | Survey distribution by last usual residence | Not a count of inter-State annual flows

- SURVEY GENDER | 86.8% of female migrants reported marriage as primary reason | Recorded reason in PLFS | Can conceal work and agency

- ADMINISTRATION | e-Shram: over 31.48 crore unorganised-worker registrations as on 26 January 2026 | Registration universe | Not migrant headcount or welfare outcome

- LABOUR CONTEXT | July 2026 CWS: LFPR 55.4%, WPR 52.5%, UR 5.1% for age 15+ | Current labour-market context | Not a migration indicator
- STATUS | Census 2027 Phase II scheduled to collect migration information | Future data refresh | No final migration result
- The Census 2011 total is high because the definition includes changes in last residence across local and long-distance moves and across all durations. The public debate, by contrast, often focuses narrowly on inter-State male labour migration. Both are real, but they are different slices.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**16. Census 2011 patterns and the stock-flow firewall**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- The Census 2011 D-03 workbook provides a dated but spatially detailed baseline.
- Census 2011 D-03 indicator | Value | Correct reading
- All-duration migrants by place of last residence | 455,787,621 | Stock at enumeration, not moves during 2011
- Last residence within India | 449,917,418 | Internal-origin stock under D-03
- Within State, outside place of enumeration | 395,652,669 | About 87.9% of within-India stock
- Beyond State of enumeration | 54,264,749 | About 12.1% of within-India stock
- Rural-origin to rural-destination stock identifiable in matrix | 213,759,232 | Largest identifiable rural-urban stream
- Female migrants reporting marriage | 205,839,698 | About 66.5% of all female migrants in D-03
- Male work/employment plus business reasons | 37,699,844 | About 25.8% of all male migrants; leading explicitly economic categories, not a majority of every male reason
- Why Census and PLFS shares differ
- Census and PLFS use different instruments, reference periods and operational residence concepts.
- Census covers the population at a decennial reference date; PLFS is a sample survey during a pandemic-affected year.
- The set of reason categories and respondent interpretation differ.
- PLFS's six-month usual-residence threshold and temporary-visitor module separate some short movement.
- **Exam rule:** quote only one instrument in one sentence unless the purpose is explicitly to compare definitions.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

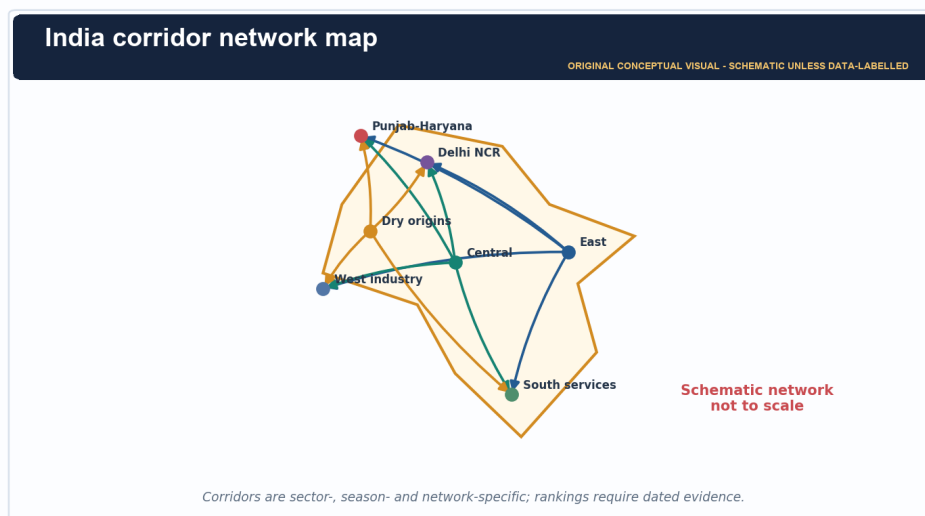
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

17. India's migration corridor network

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

INDIA'S MIGRATION CORRIDOR NETWORK



The map is a schematic of well-established corridor logics, not a ranked 2026 flow map.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Broad source geographies
- densely populated and agrarian districts of Uttar Pradesh and Bihar;
- eastern and central belts of Jharkhand, Odisha, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh;
- drought-prone and tribal pockets in Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Telangana and other States;
- hill and border regions with narrow local labour markets;
- within-State rural origins feeding the nearest town, district centre and State capital.
- Broad destination geographies
- Delhi NCR and other large northern urban labour markets;
- Mumbai-Pune and Maharashtra's industrial-service belt;
- Gujarat's manufacturing, construction and trading centres;
- Punjab-Haryana agricultural, logistics and construction zones;
- Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kerala and other southern urban/service markets;
- mines, industrial corridors, ports, brick-kiln belts, plantations and infrastructure projects.
- These are **illustrative, source-safe corridor families**, not a claim that every State pair has the same volume in 2026. Corridor intensity varies by district, season, occupation, recruiter, transport cost and network history.
- Why corridors persist
- Expected income initiates some movement; networks specify the destination; contractors connect worksites; train routes lower cost; language and caste/community ties structure housing and occupation; cumulative causation reproduces the route.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**18. Internal streams: rural-rural is not a footnote**
GS-I / GS-II
 Geography
INTERNAL STREAMS: RURAL-RURAL IS NOT A FOOTNOTE

Settlement-direction streams carry different motives, gender patterns and policy needs.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Stream | Dominant mechanisms | Exam significance
- Rural-rural | Marriage, agricultural labour, family movement, local land and kinship relations | Largest identifiable Census 2011 stream; prevents urban bias
- Rural-urban | Work, education, services, distress, construction and industry | Links regional inequality with urbanisation
- Urban-urban | Education, professional mobility, transfers, business and city hierarchy | Shows mature urban network and skill circulation
- Urban-rural | Return, retirement, crisis, peri-urban reclassification and household strategy | Small in conventional narratives but important for return and sprawl
- Seasonal/circular | Repeated work linked to harvest, kiln, construction or project cycles | Most important for portability and undercount
- Transhumant | Customary seasonal movement between pastures | Ecological livelihood, not urban labour migration
- Migration, natural increase and reclassification are separate contributors to urban growth. A rural settlement becoming a census town raises the urban population without anyone moving. A city can grow by births exceeding deaths even with modest net migration.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

19. Labour migration: circularity, informality and recruitment

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Labour migration from eastern, central, rural, tribal and drought-prone regions supplies construction, manufacturing, agriculture, brick kilns, mines, transport, domestic work, hospitality and other services. The analytical core is not a single national number but the employment relation.
- Seasonal and circular system
- Origin debt or lean season → recruiter/network → transport advance → worksite → wage/remittance → return → repeat
- The system can provide income smoothing and access to opportunity. It can also create:
 - tied advances and opaque deductions;
 - irregular wage payment;
 - hazardous work and weak injury reporting;
 - crowded or employer-linked housing;
 - documentation and language barriers;
 - exclusion of accompanying children from school and childcare;
 - dependence on a contractor for job, transport and grievance access.
- **Circularity is not failure to settle.** It may be a rational strategy to retain land, family care, identity and fallback options. Policy should support safe multi-local lives rather than assume every worker must permanently urbanise.
- Labour-code current status
- The four Labour Codes came into effect on 21 November 2025 according to the Ministry of Labour and Employment. Official 2025-26 releases state that the inter-State migrant-worker definition includes contractor-recruited and self-migrated workers, with annual lump-sum travel allowance and portability provisions. Legal provision, rule, enforcement, worker awareness, utilisation and outcome remain separate monitoring stages.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

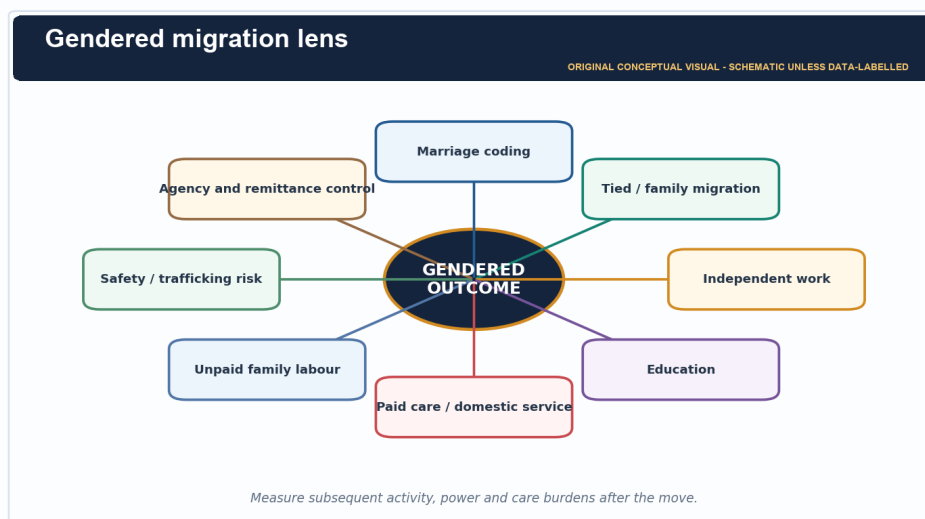
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

20. Gendered migration: recorded reason versus lived work

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

GENDERED MIGRATION: RECORDED REASON VERSUS LIVED WORK



Gender shapes motive coding, agency, occupation, safety, care and control over remittances.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Marriage-dominated recorded reasons

- PLFS 2020-21 records marriage as the reason for 86.8% of female migrants. Census 2011 D-03 records marriage for about 66.5% of female migrants under its broader all-duration stock. The difference is not a contradiction to hide; it is a reminder that instruments differ.

- What the category can conceal

- A woman recorded as a marriage migrant may subsequently farm, run an enterprise, undertake domestic service, provide unpaid family labour or join paid work. A single primary-reason code can erase economic contribution and later mobility.

- Other gendered streams

- independent migration for education and skilled employment;

- domestic and care work;

- tied or family migration following an earning member;

- female-headed split households at origin;

- trafficking risk, which must not be conflated with migration or migrant smuggling;

- return linked to marriage breakdown, care duties or unsafe work.

- Agency and constraint

- Migration can widen income, autonomy and networks. It can also intensify surveillance, unsafe transport, rental discrimination, care burden and workplace vulnerability. Class, caste, religion, age, marital status and disability intersect with gender.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

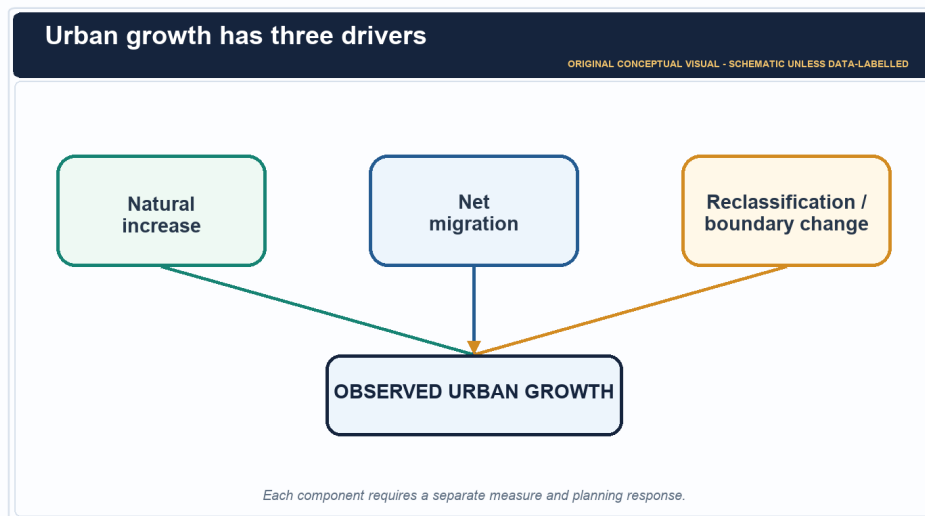
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

21. Urbanisation: three drivers and the city labour market

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

URBANISATION: THREE DRIVERS AND THE CITY LABOUR MARKET



Urban population change must be decomposed into natural increase, net migration and reclassification/boundary change.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Why large cities attract more migrants
- diversified job portfolios raise the probability of finding some work;
- agglomeration creates thick labour, product and service markets;
- education, health and administrative services are concentrated;
- transport connectivity and established networks reduce entry costs;
- informal sectors provide low-barrier, though insecure, entry;
- large construction and infrastructure cycles create episodic demand.
- Why smaller towns can intercept flows
- Stouffer's intervening opportunities predicts that a nearer town with acceptable work, education and housing can capture movement. Strong intermediate towns can reduce forced metropolitan concentration without restricting mobility.
- Urban effects
- Migration contributes labour, entrepreneurship, demographic renewal and cultural exchange. Exclusionary land and rental markets can push workers into informal settlements or long commutes. Congestion is not proof that migrants are a burden; it often reveals under-financed planning, exclusion from formal housing and failure to price the labour contribution into urban service finance.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

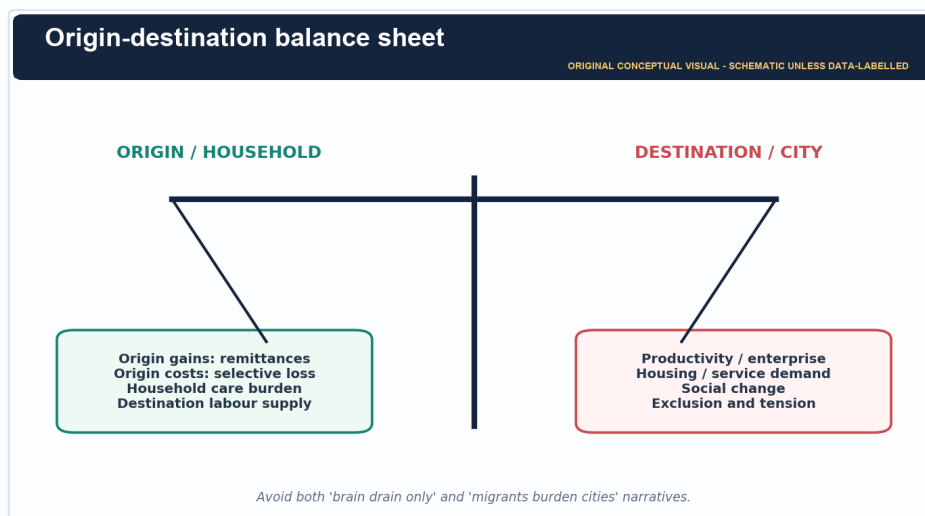
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

22. Origin and destination balance sheet

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

ORIGIN AND DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET



Migration redistributes benefits and costs across households, firms, places and time.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Dimension | Origin region | Destination region
- Labour | Can ease land pressure; may create seasonal scarcity | Adds workers, skills and flexibility
- Income | Remittances support consumption and investment | Firms and households gain services and production
- Demography | Selective loss alters age-sex composition | Working-age inflow can rejuvenate population
- Agriculture | Wages can rise; feminisation and mechanisation may increase | Receives food and workers through interregional links
- Care | Elderly, children and women may bear separation costs | Care and domestic-service markets expand
- Skills | Return can transfer knowledge; brain drain is possible | Agglomeration and innovation benefit
- Inequality | Households with migration access may advance faster | Labour-market segmentation can deepen
- Services | Reduced local demand in depopulating pockets | Housing, water, transport, school and health demand rises
- Culture | New norms and aspirations return | Diversity grows; backlash can emerge
- Balanced verdict
- Remittances can reduce poverty and smooth shocks, but effects vary by household assets, gender control, local finance and investment opportunity. Labour scarcity can raise wages yet burden small farmers. Migration can empower women yet intensify unpaid care. Destination productivity gains coexist with fiscal and housing demand. A good answer avoids both romanticising migration and blaming migrants for planning failure.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

23. Rural transformation, agriculture and left-behind households

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Migration changes rural production through:
 - remittance-financed consumption, schooling, housing, health and debt repayment;
 - labour scarcity, higher peak-season wages and altered crop choice;
 - mechanisation or reduced cultivation where labour and capital responses differ;
 - feminisation of agriculture without automatic land rights or decision power;
 - care responsibilities for elderly persons, children and persons with disabilities;
 - new skills, ideas, political expectations and consumption norms;
 - unequal gains between migrant and non-migrant households;
 - dependence on remittance streams vulnerable to destination shocks.
- **Source-region development test:** remittance-built houses are visible, but development transformation requires productive employment, public services, capabilities and reduced distress. Receipt of remittances is evidence of a financial link, not proof that structural transformation has occurred.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

24. Return and reverse migration

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Return migration must be classified by trigger:
 - Type | Trigger | Policy need
 - Crisis-driven | Lockdown, conflict, job loss, disaster, deportation or family emergency | Immediate transport, income, shelter and documentation
 - Opportunity-driven | Enterprise, remote work, local job, retirement or care choice | Credit, market links, skills and local services
 - Circular scheduled return | Agricultural calendar, contract completion or festival cycle | Portable benefits and predictable transport
 - Assisted international return | Consular operation, irregular-status resolution or crisis | Legal support, recognition and reintegration
- The 2020 pandemic made circular labour visible but should not freeze analysis in that year. Reintegration depends on skill recognition, local demand, credit, land, social acceptance and whether return was voluntary. A returnee may re-migrate if the original regional opportunity gap persists.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

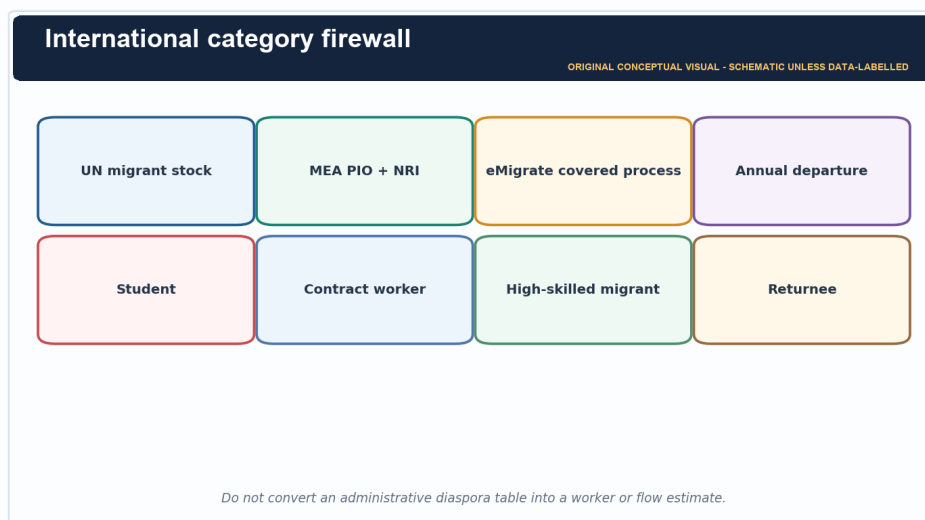
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

25. International migration from India: category discipline

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

INTERNATIONAL MIGRATION FROM INDIA: CATEGORY DISCIPLINE



MEA diaspora, UN migrant stock, RBI remittance senders and eMigrate processes describe different universes.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Main streams
- temporary and contract labour to Gulf countries;
- high-skilled professional migration to advanced economies;
- students and early-career mobility;
- family reunion and permanent settlement;
- seafarers and project workers;
- irregular migration and unsafe recruitment;
- return and circular international mobility.
- Dated status
- UN DESA's 2024 origin-based series, cited in RBI's 2025 survey article, places the international migrant stock originating from India at about 18.5 million in 2024.
- IOM's World Migration Report 2026 estimates 304 million international migrants globally by mid-2024, about 3.7% of world population.
- MEA's January 2026 table reports PIOs and NRIs separately by country. For example, it reports 4,326,248 NRIs in the UAE and 2,747,551 in Saudi Arabia. These are not worker counts and not annual departures.

- eMigrate is the official platform for covered emigration processes, recruiting-agent verification and complaints, especially for ECR-country employment. It does not capture every Indian moving abroad.
- Governance principle
- Safe recruitment, transparent contracts, pre-departure orientation, skill certification, insurance, consular grievance systems and bilateral social-security cooperation must cover the whole migration cycle.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

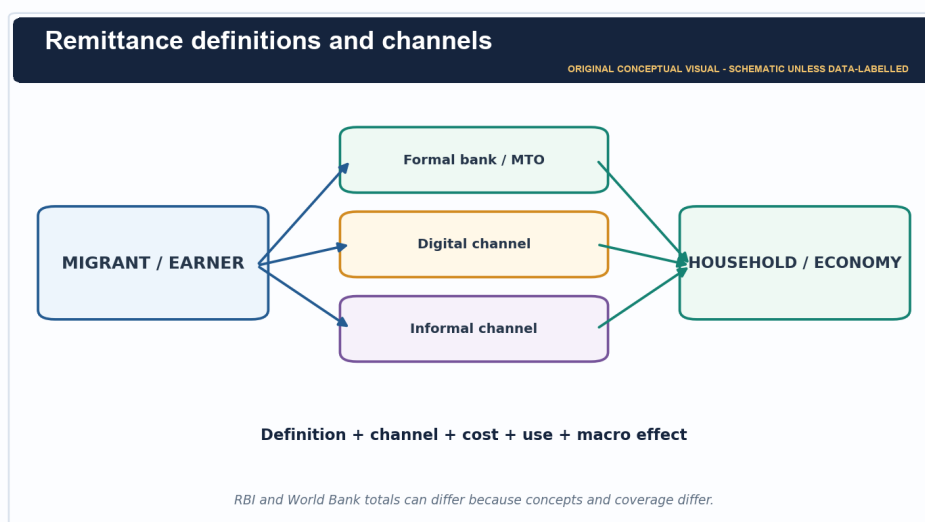
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

26. Remittances: definitions, channels and development limits

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

REMITTANCES: DEFINITIONS, CHANNELS AND DEVELOPMENT LIMITS



Remittance measures differ because balance-of-payments concepts, survey coverage and informal channels differ.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- RBI explains that cross-border remittances relate mainly to **compensation of employees** in the primary-income account and **personal transfers** in the secondary-income account. India's inward-remittance survey focuses on family maintenance and savings channels and covered banks accounting for about 99% of the reported value in its survey universe, plus selected money-transfer operators and fintechs.
- Dated indicator | Value | Boundary
- RBI inward remittances, 2023-24 | US\$118.7 billion | RBI article and survey framework
- World Bank personal remittances received, 2025 | US\$150.7 billion | Indicator BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT, current US dollars
- US share in RBI 2023-24 source-country survey | 27.7% | Banks and specified components
- UAE share | 19.2% | Same survey
- GCC combined share | 38% | Same survey
- Cost of sending US\$200 to India, 2023 | 4.9% | RBI citing corridor-cost database; below global average, above SDG 3% target

- Digital remittance cost to India, Q2 2024 | 4.0% | Dated transaction-channel estimate
- The World Bank and RBI values should not be forced to match: reference year, balance-of-payments components, revisions and statistical coverage differ.
- Household and macro effects
- Remittances can smooth consumption, reduce poverty, finance education and health, support housing and provide foreign exchange. They can also reinforce inequality between connected and unconnected households, raise land/housing prices, create dependency and expose families to destination shocks. Exchange rates, transfer fees, digital access and informal channels affect the amount received.

MAINS ANGLE

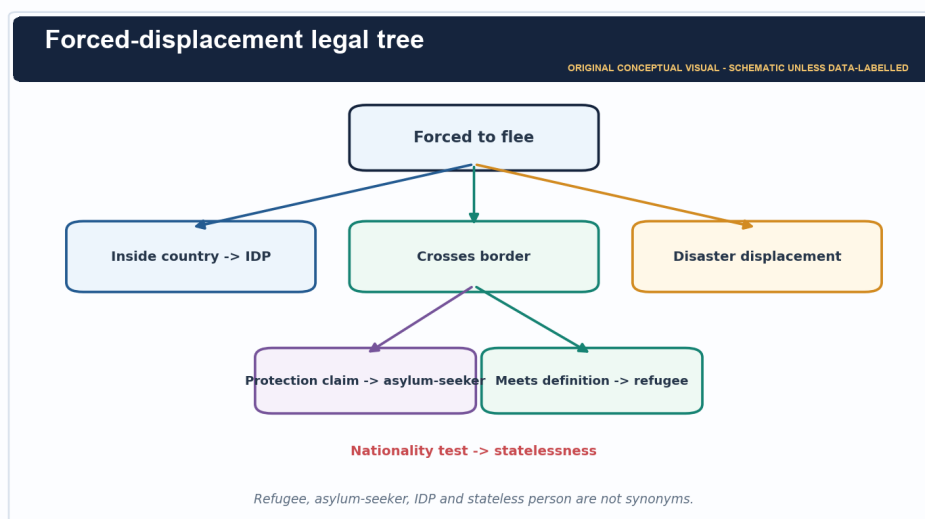
Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**27. Forced displacement and the legal tree**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

FORCED DISPLACEMENT AND THE LEGAL TREE

Border crossing and legal grounds distinguish refugee and asylum categories from internal displacement.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- UNHCR's current definitions:
- a **refugee** has fled their country and cannot safely return because of feared persecution, conflict, violence or serious public disorder under the applicable framework;
- an **asylum-seeker** seeks international protection while the claim is pending or intended;
- an **IDP** is forced to flee by conflict, violence, persecution or disaster but remains within their country;
- a **stateless person** is not considered a national by any State under the operation of its law.
- At end-December 2025, UNHCR reports 41.6 million refugees, around 9 million asylum-seekers and 68.6 million IDPs globally. These categories, mandates and rounding rules must be respected.
- India-context caution

- Do not import a global label into an Indian case without checking cause, border crossing, nationality and governing law. Do not call every informal settler, disaster evacuee or project-displaced household a refugee. Protection needs may be severe even when the refugee category does not apply.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**28. Development-induced displacement**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Development projects can displace people physically, economically or culturally through:
 - dams and reservoirs;
 - mining and industrial zones;
 - transport and energy infrastructure;
 - urban renewal, highways and public projects;
 - conservation restrictions and protected-area interventions.
- Loss matrix
 - Loss | Why cash compensation alone may fail
 - Land and house | Replacement markets, title and valuation differ
 - Common property | Forest, grazing, water and fishing access may be unpriced
 - Livelihood | Skills and market location cannot be instantly replaced
 - Culture and identity | Sacred sites, community institutions and territorial memory are place-specific
 - Social networks | Credit, care and labour-sharing systems fragment
 - Public services | New sites may lack school, health, transport and documents
- The Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013 provides a relevant statutory frame, but **land acquisition completed** is not equivalent to **livelihood rehabilitation achieved**. Monitor income restoration, tenure, services, social cohesion and grievance outcomes after relocation.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

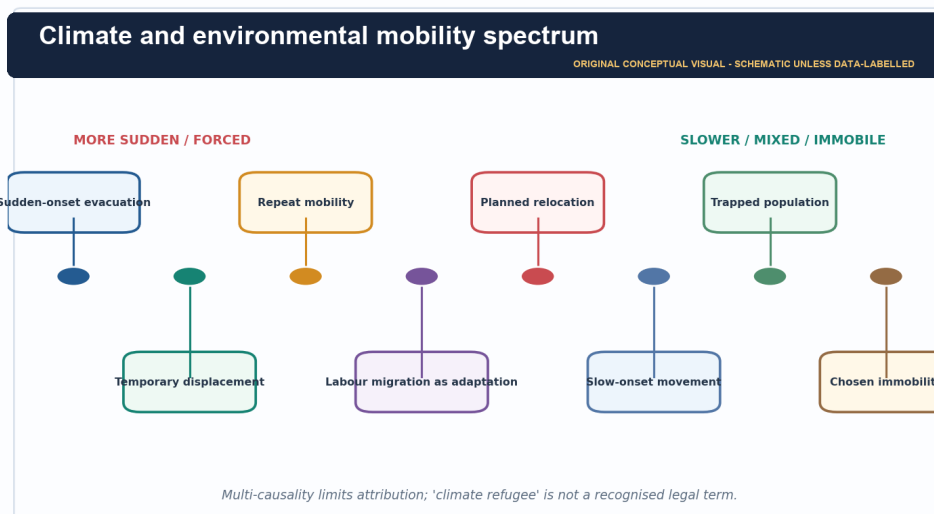
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

29. Climate and environmental mobility

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

CLIMATE AND ENVIRONMENTAL MOBILITY



Climate-related mobility ranges from evacuation and seasonal adaptation to displacement, planned relocation and immobility.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Sudden-onset pathways

- Cyclones, floods, landslides, wildfires and extreme heat can produce evacuation, temporary displacement, repeated relocation or permanent movement.

- Slow-onset pathways

- Sea-level rise, salinisation, erosion, desertification, glacial change, water stress and livelihood decline can alter migration over years. Attribution is difficult because jobs, debt, land, policy, conflict and networks interact with environmental change.

- Adaptation, failure and trapped populations

- Migration can be an adaptation when it diversifies income and reduces exposure. It can indicate adaptation failure when movement is forced after asset collapse. Some people become **trapped** because they lack money, health, networks or legal access to move. Others choose immobility because identity, livelihood and care are place-bound.

- Legal trap

- UNHCR cautions that "climate refugee" is not a recognised term in international law. A disaster-displaced person may be an IDP if remaining within the country; cross-border protection depends on the applicable legal grounds and circumstances.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

30. Governance and rights architecture

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

GOVERNANCE AND RIGHTS ARCHITECTURE



Policy success requires movement from registration to eligibility, portability, use and outcome.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Constitutional and ethical foundation
- Citizens' freedom of movement and residence, equality, dignity and non-discrimination establish a rights-based starting point. Planning for migrants is not charity; migrants are residents, workers, consumers, caregivers and rights-holders.
- Current instruments
 - **e-Shram**: over 31.48 crore unorganised workers registered as on 26 January 2026; One-Stop-Solution integrates schemes. Registration must be followed by updating, eligibility and use.
 - **ONORC**: enabled across all 36 States/UTs and around 80 crore NFSA beneficiaries in the latest retrieved year-end review. It recorded more than 158.8 crore cumulative portability transactions by that 2024 review. The total combines intra-State and inter-State use.
 - **Labour Codes**: effective 21 November 2025; official releases identify expanded inter-State migrant-worker coverage, annual travel allowance and benefit portability.
 - **eMigrate/MEA**: recruiting-agent verification, emigration processing and grievance channels for covered overseas workers.
 - **Urban rental and worker accommodation**: affordable rental housing, hostels, dormitories and tenure security should be treated as labour-market infrastructure.
- Missing middle
 - Health, school admission, childcare, occupational safety, skill recognition, banking, legal aid, voting access, language support and grievance redress remain fragmented across origin and destination institutions. Portability should be family-aware: the worker may move while ration, children and elderly dependants remain at origin.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

31. Current 2026 dashboard

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Tag | Item | Dated status | Correct inference and limit
- STATUS | Census 2027 | Houselisting during 2026; Population Enumeration scheduled; migration information to be collected | No final migration table exists
- FACT | PLFS July 2026 | LFPR 55.4%, WPR 52.5%, UR 5.1% for age 15+ under CWS | Labour-market context, not migrant outcomes
- FACT | e-Shram | 31.48 crore registrations as on 26 January 2026 | Administrative stock, not migrant count
- STATUS | Labour Codes | In effect from 21 November 2025 | Provision does not prove enforcement or outcome
- FACT | ONORC | Nationwide architecture; retrieved official operational totals are from year-end 2024 | Do not call dated totals current 2026 use
- ESTIMATE | IOM WMR 2026 | 304 million international migrants by mid-2024, 3.7% of world population | Modelled global stock
- FACT | UN DESA stock | 2024 edition covers 233 countries/areas, 1990-2024 | Some countries fully reassessed; others extrapolated
- FACT | World Bank remittances | India: US\$150.7 billion personal remittances received in 2025 | Current-US-dollar series, not RBI survey
- FACT | RBI remittance survey | US\$118.7 billion in 2023-24; advanced economies' share exceeded GCC share | Survey definition and year differ
- FACT | UNHCR end-2025 | 41.6m refugees, about 9m asylum-seekers, 68.6m IDPs | Legal categories and mandate boundaries matter
- INFERENCE | India mobility | Circular and multi-local movement likely exceeds what usual-residence measures capture | Direction plausible; no invented national count
- LIMIT | Climate mobility | No dedicated official national 2026 climate-migrant count found | Multi-causality and attribution prevent guessing

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

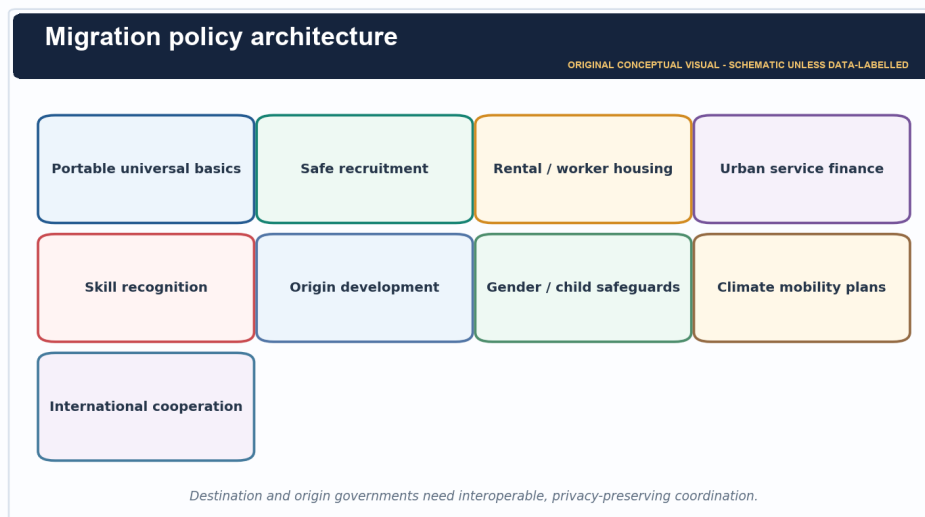
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

32. Policy architecture

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

POLICY ARCHITECTURE



The policy goal is safe, productive and rights-compatible mobility, not immobility.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- 1. **Portable universal basics:** food, primary health, school entry, childcare, social security and grievance access.
- 2. **Safe recruitment:** registered intermediaries, written contracts, fee transparency, wage traceability and multilingual helplines.
- 3. **Housing as infrastructure:** rental supply, worker hostels, dormitories, serviced land and protection against arbitrary eviction.
- 4. **Urban service finance:** count mobile populations in transport, water, sanitation, health and school planning.
- 5. **Data interoperability with privacy:** federated identifiers, consent, purpose limitation, updating and audit; avoid a coercive movement-surveillance system.
- 6. **Source-region development:** irrigation, climate resilience, non-farm work, education, connectivity and intermediate towns.
- 7. **Skill portability:** recognition of prior learning, portable credentials and destination job matching.
- 8. **Gender and child safeguards:** safe transport, childcare, maternity protection, domestic-worker protection and school continuity.
- 9. **Climate and disaster mobility plans:** evacuation, temporary shelter, planned relocation, tenure and return/reintegration protocols.
- 10. **International cooperation:** ethical recruitment, social-security agreements, consular capacity, remittance-cost reduction and reintegration.
- Policy must coordinate origin and destination governments because the migrant household is often split across both.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

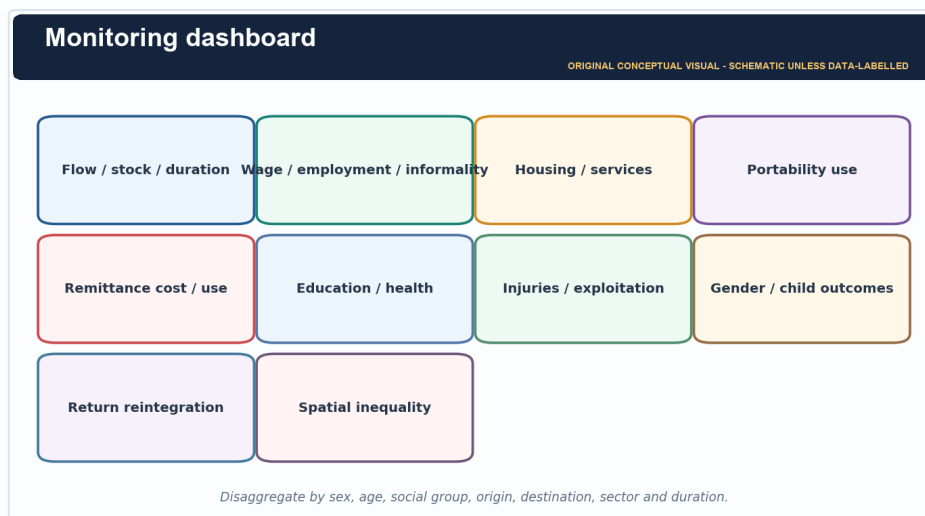
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

33. Monitoring indicators

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

MONITORING INDICATORS



A dashboard must track movement, work, services, rights and spatial distribution rather than one registration total.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Domain | Minimum indicators
- Movement | stock, flows, origin-destination, duration, repeat movement, return and circularity
- Work | employment rate, wages, hours, informality, contract, skill match and unemployment
- Safety | injuries, deaths, compensation, harassment, forced labour and recruiter complaints
- Housing | rent burden, crowding, tenure, commute and access to water/sanitation
- Portability | eligibility, successful use, failure reason and grievance resolution by scheme
- Children | enrolment, attendance, childcare, nutrition and protection
- Gender | independent migration, occupation, wage, control over remittances, safety and care burden
- Health | access, insurance use, occupational disease and continuity of treatment
- Remittances | formal/informal channel, cost, frequency, use and recipient control
- Return | time to employment, enterprise survival, skill use and re-migration
- Spatial equity | origin/destination service pressure, wage convergence and regional inequality
- Data quality | coverage, duplication, update lag, privacy breach and comparability
- Disaggregate by sex, age, disability, caste/tribe where lawful and relevant, sector, duration and migration type. Averages can hide the most exposed corridors.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

34. Migration policy ethics

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Migration policy must balance local planning with freedom, dignity and non-discrimination.
- Ethical principles
- **Freedom and agency:** people should not be forced to remain in distressed regions or coerced into unsafe movement.
- **Non-discrimination:** local residence or origin should not justify denial of basic rights.
- **Family unity:** policy should recognise split households and facilitate reunion where desired.
- **Labour rights:** a worker's mobility must not weaken wage, safety or grievance protection.
- **Proportionality:** data and enforcement tools should be necessary, limited and reviewable.
- **Voice:** migrants should participate in urban and workplace decisions affecting them.
- **Just transition:** planned relocation should preserve livelihood, culture, tenure and choice.
- False choices to reject
- local workers versus migrants;
- city efficiency versus migrant rights;
- source development versus freedom to move;
- disaster safety versus consent;
- data interoperability versus privacy.
- A rights-compatible policy improves conditions for all low-income workers and residents while addressing corridor-specific vulnerabilities.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

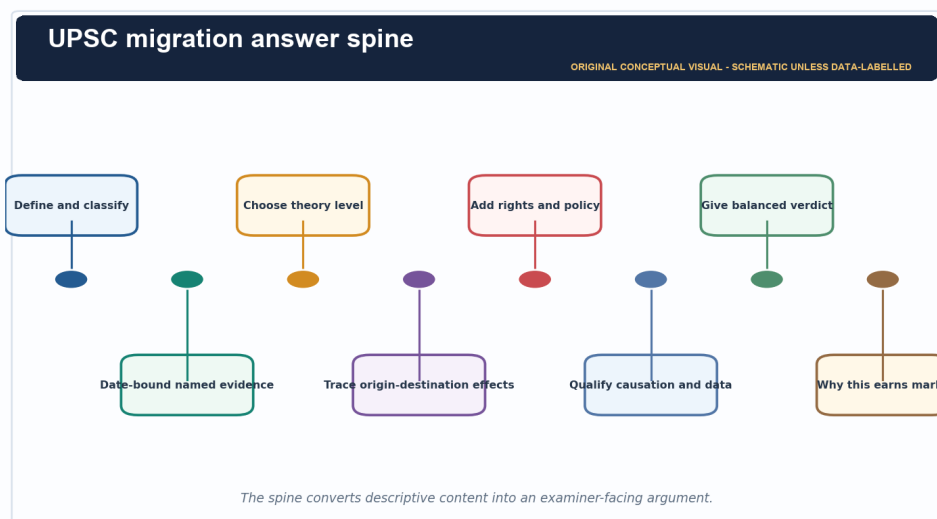
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

35. UPSC answer spine

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

UPSC ANSWER SPINE



Every strong migration answer moves from definition and scale to named evidence, mechanism, qualification and verdict.

Original conceptual visual created for this package; schematic unless explicitly data-labelled.

STATIC THEORY

- Universal structure
- 1. **Define and delimit:** movement type, boundary, duration and data status.
- 2. **State thesis:** migration is multi-causal and spatially selective.
- 3. **Name theory:** choose two or three models at different explanation levels.
- 4. **Use dated evidence:** Census 2011, PLFS 2020-21, or current administrative status with label.
- 5. **Analyse both ends:** migrant/household, origin and destination.
- 6. **Qualify:** circular undercount, gender coding, informality, multi-causality or legal category.
- 7. **Give a rights-compatible policy route.**
- 8. **Verdict:** enable safe mobility while reducing involuntary distress and spatial concentration of opportunity.
- Directive discipline
- Directive | Required move | Common failure
- Discuss | Present dimensions and a balanced judgement | One-sided list
- Examine | Test a proposition with evidence and limits | Mere description
- Analyse | Show causal links and interaction | Unconnected points
- Critically analyse | Explain value, expose limits and reach a graded verdict | Criticism without utility
- Evaluate | Apply explicit criteria and weigh performance | Scheme inventory

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

36. Solved verified PYQ - 2024 GS-I Q5

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Locally verified official-paper wording, spelling normalised from scan extraction:

- "Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries." **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Demand decoding

- The question asks for a mechanism, not a list of amenities. Use expected income, opportunity diversity, agglomeration and networks; then qualify with intervening opportunities and urban costs.

- Model answer

- **Claim:** Large cities attract migrants because they concentrate a wider **portfolio of opportunities**, not merely a higher observed wage.

- **Named evidence/example:** Harris-Todaro's expected-income model explains movement when the urban wage weighted by the probability of obtaining work exceeds the rural alternative. In developing-country metros, construction, transport, retail, domestic work, manufacturing and services offer multiple entry points. Migrant networks further reduce information, housing and job-search costs.

- **Analysis:** Agglomeration also concentrates education, health, finance and connectivity. This creates cumulative causation: earlier flows build networks that make later flows easier. Smaller towns often lack sectoral diversity and may lose functions to higher-order cities.

- **Qualification:** Visible unemployment and informality show that attraction does not guarantee secure structural transformation. Stouffer's intervening opportunities also predicts that well-connected intermediate towns can intercept flows, while high rent and commuting costs reduce metropolitan gains.

- **Verdict:** The remedy is not mobility restriction but productive intermediate towns, affordable rental housing, transport and portable services.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers "why" through named theory, applies it to developing-country labour markets, adds a counter-model and ends with a spatial policy verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

37. Solved verified PYQ - 2024 GS-I Q19

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Locally verified official-paper wording:

- "Globalization has increased urban migration by skilled, young, unmarried women from various classes. How has this trend impacted upon their personal freedom and relationship with family?" **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** Skilled women's urban migration can expand substantive freedom, but outcomes depend on class, safety, work conditions and family bargaining.

- **Named evidence/example:** Professional and education-led migration to Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Delhi NCR, Mumbai and other cities can provide independent income, peer networks, delayed marriage, occupational identity and greater control over consumption. Digital communication and cheaper travel help sustain family ties across distance.
- **Analysis:** Spatial separation can renegotiate household authority. Women may choose residence, partners and careers with less immediate surveillance. Remittances can increase their voice at origin. Urban anonymity and diverse networks can weaken restrictive norms.
- **Qualification:** Freedom is uneven. Rental discrimination, unsafe transport, workplace harassment and high care costs constrain autonomy. Families may exercise digital surveillance or expect daughters to provide money and care from a distance. Class changes the experience: secure professionals can purchase safety and services, while domestic and informal workers face employer-linked housing, weak contracts and greater exploitation. Migration may postpone rather than remove gendered care duties.
- **Verdict:** Urban migration is an enabling condition, not automatic emancipation. Safe transport, rental access, childcare, equal work and responsive policing must convert spatial mobility into capability.
- **Why this earns marks:** It follows the question's two axes—personal freedom and family relations—uses named city examples, includes class variation and reaches a qualified gender-sensitive verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**38. Solved verified PYQ - 2018 GS-I Q13**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**STATIC THEORY****- Locally verified official-paper wording:**

- "Why indentured labour was taken by the British from India to other colonies? Have they been able to preserve their cultural identity over there?" **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** Indentured migration arose from post-emancipation plantation labour demand joined to colonial poverty, coercive recruitment and imperial transport networks; cultural identity survived through adaptation rather than isolation.

- **Named evidence/example:** After slavery's abolition, British colonies required controlled labour for sugar and other plantations. Recruiters drew workers from impoverished, indebted and famine-affected regions under contracts that workers often poorly understood. Indians moved to Mauritius, Fiji, the Caribbean, South Africa and elsewhere through an empire-wide labour system.

- **Analysis:** The system reduced employers' labour uncertainty while transferring recruitment and voyage risks to workers. At destination, racial hierarchy, plantation discipline and demographic imbalance constrained freedom. Yet migrants recreated community through Bhojpuri and other languages, religion, festivals, food, music, kinship and voluntary associations.

- **Qualification:** Preservation was not unchanged continuity. Creolisation, inter-regional mixing, conversion, new political identities and host-society influence transformed culture. Some practices weakened; others became stronger symbols of collective memory. Later generations' political and economic trajectories differed across colonies.

- **Verdict:** Indenture was a coercive colonial labour-migration regime. Its descendants preserved an identifiable Indian cultural inheritance, but as plural diasporic cultures adapted to local histories.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both “why” and “have they,” names destination regions, links labour demand with colonial vulnerability and avoids treating culture as static.

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

39. Solved verified PYQ - 2020 GS-II Q10

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- **Locally verified official-paper wording:**

- “Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries’. Comment with examples.” **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** The Indian diaspora influences host economies and politics through skills, enterprise, civic participation and transnational networks, but “decisive” should be used selectively.

- **Named evidence/example:** Indian-origin professionals are prominent in technology, medicine, research, finance and entrepreneurship in the United States, United Kingdom and Europe. Community organisations, elected representatives and policy professionals can articulate interests, support bilateral relations and mobilise philanthropy and investment.

- **Analysis:** Diaspora networks reduce information costs for trade, innovation and skilled mobility. Their success contributes to India’s soft power and creates channels for knowledge exchange and remittances.

- **Qualification:** Diaspora is internally diverse by generation, class, religion and political preference; it does not act as one bloc. Host-country citizenship and interests shape behaviour, and influence is stronger in particular sectors and constituencies than across the whole political economy.

- **Verdict:** The diaspora is an important bridge, not an instrument controlled by India; engagement should combine welfare, plural cultural representation and mutually beneficial mobility.

- **Why this earns marks:** It comments rather than merely praises, gives economic and political mechanisms, and qualifies the word “decisive.”

MAINS ANGLE

Use *claim* → *named evidence/example* → *analysis* → *qualification* → *verdict*. End with a *rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement*.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

40. Solved verified PYQ - 2023 GS-II Q10

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Locally verified official-paper wording:

- "Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India." **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** A successful diaspora benefits India through capital, knowledge, markets, representation and crisis support.

- **Named evidence/example:** High-skilled Indian communities in the US, UK, Canada, Australia and Europe connect firms and universities, support technology transfer, expand markets for Indian services and contribute remittances. Political representatives and civic organisations can improve understanding of India's interests and strengthen people-to-people ties.

- **Analysis:** Diaspora social capital lowers transaction costs for investment, research collaboration, tourism and talent circulation. Philanthropy and professional networks can support health, education and disaster response.

- **Qualification:** Benefits are not automatic: brain drain, unequal mobility access, political polarisation and unsafe low-wage migration coexist with high-skilled success. Diaspora numbers should not be confused with international migrant stock or annual emigration.

- **Verdict:** India should pursue welfare-centred consular protection, skills partnerships and knowledge circulation while respecting the diaspora's autonomous host-country citizenship.

- **Why this earns marks:** It directly describes economic and political benefits, adds named regions and inserts the essential diversity and data-category caveat.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

41. Solved verified Prelims PYQ - 2024 Set-A Q75

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Which one of the following statements is correct as per the Constitution of India?

- A. Inter-State trade and commerce is a State subject under the State List.

- B. Inter-State migration is a State subject under the State List.

- C. Inter-State quarantine is a Union subject under the Union List.

- D. Corporation tax is a State subject under the State List.

- **Official Set-A key: C.**

- **Explanation:** Inter-State quarantine is in the Union List. Inter-State trade and commerce and inter-State migration are not State List subjects as framed in the distractors, and corporation tax is not a State List tax. This is a constitutional-list cross-link, not a migration-measurement question.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**42. Learning MCQ loop I - concepts and measurement**
GS-I / GS-II
 Geography
STATIC THEORY

- Q1

- Which statement best distinguishes migrant stock from migration flow?

- A. Stock is the number meeting a migration definition at a point/date; flow counts movements during an interval.

- B. Stock records only international migrants; flow records internal migrants.

- C. Stock is always census-based; flow is always administrative.

- D. Stock excludes return migrants; flow includes them.

- **Answer: A.** Stock-flow distinction is temporal, not national or instrument-specific.

- Q2

- With reference to migration effectiveness, which formula is most defensible when direction is retained?

- A. In-migration divided by out-migration.

- B. $(\text{In} - \text{Out}) / (\text{In} + \text{Out}) \times 100$.

- C. Gross migration divided by total population without a time period.

- D. Migrant stock divided by births.

- **Answer: B.** The denominator captures total turnover; the sign indicates direction. State the convention.

- Q3

- Which of the following is most likely to be missed by a six-month usual-residence threshold?

- A. A person settled for ten years in a metropolis.

- B. A person born abroad and now permanently resident.

- C. A worker repeatedly spending three-month construction seasons away from the village.

- D. A household that moved after marriage and remained for five years.

- **Answer: C.** Short repeated movement may remain below the residence threshold.

- Q4

- Which statement about the MoSPI 2020-21 migration report is correct?

- A. Its migration rate is an annual border-crossing rate.

- B. Its appendix migrant totals are intended as a current national headcount.

- C. It uses birthplace alone.

- D. It classifies migrants by last usual residence different from present enumeration, with a six-month residence/intention rule.

- **Answer: D.** The report's concept and caution must travel with the rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

43. Learning MCQ loop II - theories and India

GS-I / GS-II

Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Q5

- Which pairing is most accurate?

- A. Stouffer - nearer acceptable opportunities can intercept a longer-distance flow.

- B. Ravenstein - migration has no counter-stream.

- C. Todaro - migrants compare only observed formal wages.

- D. NELM - the individual is always the sole decision-maker.

- **Answer: A.** The other options reverse or narrow the theories.

- Q6

- Why can migration continue despite visible urban unemployment in Harris-Todaro logic?

- A. Rural wages are assumed zero in every case.

- B. Expected urban income can exceed the rural alternative after weighting wages by employment probability and fallback opportunities.

- C. Migrants possess perfect information by definition.

- D. All migrants seek permanent formal employment.

- **Answer: B.** Expected return, not visible unemployment alone, drives the comparison.

- Q7

- Which statement best reflects Census 2011 and PLFS 2020-21 together?

- A. Inter-State migration dominates all migration in both.

- B. Rural-rural movement is analytically irrelevant.

- C. Intra-State movement predominates, while instrument definitions and dates must remain separate.

- D. Marriage is absent as a recorded reason.

- **Answer: C.** Both sources show intra-State predominance under different instruments.

- Q8

- Which statement is incorrect?
- A. Network theory explains corridor persistence.
- B. World-systems theory highlights historical structural links.
- C. Dual labour-market theory focuses on destination demand.
- D. Push-pull alone fully specifies causal weights and predicts exact flow.
- **Answer: D.** Push-pull is a framework, not a complete predictive theory.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

44. Learning MCQ loop III - policy, remittances and displacement

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Q9
- Which is the safest reading of e-Shram's 31.48 crore registrations?
- A. It is an administrative stock of registered unorganised workers, not a migrant count or outcome.
- B. It is the number of inter-State migrant workers in 2026.
- C. It is the annual migration flow.
- D. It proves every registrant received every integrated benefit.
- **Answer: A.** Registration, category, eligibility, use and outcome are different.
- Q10
- Why can the World Bank's 2025 remittance value differ from RBI's 2023-24 inward-remittance value?
- A. One must be fabricated.
- B. Reference year, balance-of-payments definition, revisions and coverage can differ.
- C. RBI measures only domestic transfers.
- D. World Bank excludes personal transfers.
- **Answer: B.** Statistical concepts and periods must be compared before numbers.
- Q11
- Which person is an IDP?
- A. A tourist delayed by weather.
- B. A worker who commutes daily.
- C. A family forced from its home by conflict but remaining within its country.

- D. Every person who moves across an international border.
- **Answer: C.** Internal displacement requires forced movement without crossing the national border.
- Q12
- Which statement is correct?
- A. Every disaster-displaced person is a refugee.
- B. "Climate refugee" is a universally recognised legal category.
- C. Planned relocation guarantees successful rehabilitation.
- D. Climate mobility can include adaptation, displacement, planned relocation and trapped immobility.
- **Answer: D.** The spectrum and legal caution are both necessary.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**45. Remedial MCQs - common errors**

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Q13
- A region has 100,000 in-migrants and 100,000 out-migrants in one year. Which inference is correct?
- A. Net migration is zero but gross migration is 200,000.
- B. No one moved.
- C. Migration effectiveness must be 100%.
- D. Stock necessarily fell by 200,000.
- **Answer: A.** Net balance can conceal large turnover.
- Q14
- Which is the best use of Ravenstein in a Mains answer?
- A. Present every proposition as a universal natural law.
- B. Use distance, step and counter-stream propositions as historical hypotheses, then test and qualify them.
- C. Ignore gender statements entirely.
- D. Use it to calculate exact Indian flows without calibration.
- **Answer: B.** Historical context and empirical qualification are essential.
- Q15
- Which statement about urban growth is correct?

- A. It is always equal to net rural-urban migration.
- B. Reclassification has no effect on urban population.
- C. Natural increase, net migration and reclassification/boundary change are separate contributors.
- D. Migration can only increase slum population.
- **Answer: C.** Decompose growth before attributing cause.
- Q16
- Which governance sequence is analytically strongest?
- A. Outcome → registration → eligibility → use.
- B. Registration → outcome, with no intermediate stages.
- C. Portability announced → universal access proved.
- D. Registration → category accuracy → eligibility → portability → successful use → outcome.
- **Answer: D.** Each stage requires its own indicator.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**46. Original solved Mains practice - 10 marks**
GS-I / GS-II
 Geography
STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Explain why migration in India cannot be understood through an interstate rural-to-urban lens alone. **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** India's migration system combines local marriage movement, labour circulation, urban hierarchy, return and international streams.

- **Named evidence/example:** Census 2011 D-03 recorded about 87.9% of within-India migrants within the State, while rural-rural was the largest identifiable stream. PLFS 2020-21 similarly recorded 87.5% of migrants from the same State and marriage as the reason for 86.8% of female migrants.

- **Analysis:** A narrow interstate rural-urban lens therefore misses local marriage migration, inter-district movement, urban-urban professional mobility, seasonal work below usual-residence thresholds, transhumance and return. It also mistakes a broad migration stock for an annual labour flow.

- **Qualification:** Interstate labour corridors remain economically and politically important because they expose portability, housing and recruitment gaps.

- **Verdict:** India requires a multi-stream, gender-aware and duration-sensitive framework rather than one headline migrant count.

- **Why this earns marks:** It uses two dated official sources, directly disproves the narrow lens and preserves the significance of interstate labour mobility.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**47. Original solved Mains practice - 15 marks****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**STATIC THEORY**

- **Question:** Critically analyse the proposition that migration is a rational household strategy but a symptom of regional inequality. **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** The proposition is complementary rather than contradictory: households can rationally respond to an unequal spatial economy.

- **Named evidence/example:** NELM shows that households send members to diversify crop and employment risk, overcome missing credit and finance education or health. Long-standing corridors from agrarian and drought-prone districts to Delhi NCR, western industrial belts and southern cities illustrate how networks lower cost. Remittances can smooth consumption and reduce poverty.

- **Analysis:** At the regional scale, cumulative causation concentrates capital, skills and services in growth centres while lagging regions lose selective labour. Destination firms gain flexible labour, while housing and social-reproduction costs are often externalised to migrants and source households. The same flow can therefore be both opportunity-led and distress-conditioned.

- **Qualification:** Not every move signals distress; education, professional mobility, marriage and autonomy matter. Migration can transmit skills, ideas and capital back to origin, and strong intermediate towns can create spread effects. The poorest may be unable to migrate and become trapped.

- **Verdict:** Policy should protect mobility and remittances while reducing involuntary distress through source-region capabilities, intermediate-town jobs, safe recruitment, housing and portable services.

- **Why this earns marks:** It integrates household and regional theories, gives named Indian corridor logic, recognises counter-effects and reaches a non-restrictive policy verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**48. Original solved Mains practice - 20 marks****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**STATIC THEORY**

- **Question:** "Climate mobility is neither a single category nor a simple count." Analyse the conceptual, legal, data and policy implications for India. **20 marks, 300 words.**

- Model answer

- **Claim:** Climate mobility is a spectrum produced by hazard, exposure, livelihood, inequality and capability; it cannot be reduced to a "climate refugee" number.

- **Named evidence/example:** Sudden events such as floods, cyclones and landslides can cause evacuation and internal displacement. Slow processes such as salinisation, erosion, water stress and desertification can alter seasonal migration or encourage planned relocation. UNFCCC's human-mobility workstream separates migration, displacement and planned relocation, while UNHCR states that "climate refugee" is not a recognised legal term.
- **Analysis:** Legally, an IDP remains within the country; refugee status requires applicable international grounds and border crossing. Statistically, mobile-phone movement, shelter occupancy, census residence and project-relocation registers measure different objects. Attribution is multi-causal: debt, land, jobs, policy and networks mediate environmental pressure. A household may use migration as adaptation, be forced to move after asset collapse, or remain trapped because it cannot finance movement.
- **Policy:** India needs anticipatory risk maps, portable food/health/school access, urban reception planning, livelihood diversification, safe rental housing, planned-relocation standards, tenure and cultural safeguards, and origin-destination data with privacy. NDMA warning and evacuation systems should connect to recovery and durable-solution monitoring.
- **Qualification:** Not all movement from a hazard-prone area is caused by climate change, and not all immobility is vulnerability; some is chosen attachment.
- **Verdict:** Govern mobility by rights, risk and durable outcomes, while resisting legally inaccurate labels and fabricated national totals.
- **Why this earns marks:** It covers all four demanded dimensions, uses UNFCCC/UNHCR distinctions, applies them to India and ends with a measurable policy architecture.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**49. Advanced refinements****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**STATIC THEORY**

- Multi-level explanation
- A migration flow is best explained as a nested system:
 - Uneven development → destination labour demand → household strategy → personal selectivity → network corridor → cumulative reproduction
 - No single theory covers every link. A high-quality answer names the level at which each theory operates.
- Multi-local citizenship
- Circular migrants live across origin and destination. Residence-based welfare and political representation assume one stable place. Multi-local policy should permit portable basics while preserving household entitlements at origin and enabling local access at destination.
- Migration-development non-linearity
- Development can initially increase migration by raising education, aspirations, information and the ability to finance movement. Only later may particular outflows stabilise. Therefore, source-region growth does not mechanically stop migration.
- Immobility as an outcome

- The inability to move can be as important as movement. Poverty, disability, care, conflict, documentation and social exclusion can trap people in high-risk or low-opportunity places.
- Data ethics
- Mobility data can improve transport, disaster response and services, but also enable surveillance, exclusion or coercive enforcement. Use purpose limitation, minimisation, consent where appropriate, independent audit and deletion schedules.
- # Part II - Premium solved-practice workbook

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence/example → analysis → qualification → verdict. End with a rights-aware, data-disciplined judgement.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

66. Final register notes 1/10 - movement and legal vocabulary

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

MOVEMENT AND LEGAL VOCABULARY - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- **Human mobility** is broader than migration: commuting, circulation, tourism, evacuation and displacement may occur without a permanent residence shift.
- **Migration** involves movement away from usual residence; operational thresholds differ by source.
- **Circulation/circular migration** is repeated movement with continuing links to more than one place.
- **Commuting** normally preserves the same usual residence.
- **Evacuation** is organised movement from immediate danger and may be temporary.
- **Refugee**: outside own country and meeting the applicable international protection definition.
- **Asylum-seeker**: protection claim pending or intended.
- **IDP**: forced to flee but remains within the country.
- **Stateless person**: not considered a national by any State under operation of its law.
- **Migrant worker**: moves for remunerated work; internal and international legal definitions differ.
- **Diaspora**: migrants plus descendants and identity/link networks; broader than migrant stock.
- **Trap**: migrant, refugee, asylum-seeker, IDP and stateless person are not synonyms.
- **Trap**: "climate refugee" is not a recognised term in international law.

MOVEMENT AND LEGAL VOCABULARY - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

MOVEMENT AND LEGAL VOCABULARY - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

67. Final register notes 2/10 - measurement and formulas

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

MEASUREMENT AND FORMULAS - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Object | Recall line
- Place of birth | Current residence versus birthplace; misses intermediate and return moves
- Last residence | Current versus previous usual residence; misses some circulation
- Duration | Time since move; interval and recall matter
- Stock | Migrants present at a point/date
- Flow | Movement events during an interval
- Gross migration | $In + Out$
- Net migration | $In - Out$

- Migration effectiveness | $(In - Out)/(In + Out) \times 100$; state signed/absolute convention
- Lifetime/all-duration | Broad stock defined by source, not annual flow
- Recent migrant | Move within a stated interval
- Rates require **numerator + denominator + boundary + time window + multiplier**.
- Destination denominator for in-migration and origin denominator for out-migration answer different questions.
- Zero net migration can conceal high gross turnover.
- MoSPI's "migration rate" is a population share under its definition, not an annual event rate.

MEASUREMENT AND FORMULAS - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

MEASUREMENT AND FORMULAS - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

68. Final register notes 3/10 - data-source firewall

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

DATA-SOURCE FIREWALL - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- **Census**: strongest small-area stock; infrequent; circular/seasonal undercount.
- **PLFS/NSS**: reasons and labour context; sample, recall and instrument limits.
- **Administrative data**: timely for covered users; registration is not migration, utilisation or outcome.
- **Rail/mobile**: movement intensity and timing; not motive, legal status or welfare access.
- **Border/visa/eMigrate**: distinct administrative universes; not total emigration.
- **Remittance data**: formal financial links; definitions and informal channels differ.
- **Big trap**: do not merge Census 2011, PLFS 2020-21, e-Shram, MEA, UN DESA, RBI and World Bank into one "current migrant number."
- **Census 2027**: scheduled/status only; no final migration result at 19 August 2026.

DATA-SOURCE FIREWALL - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

DATA-SOURCE FIREWALL - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

69. Final register notes 4/10 - theory matrix

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

THEORY MATRIX - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Theory | One-line mechanism | Mandatory qualification
- Ravenstein | Short distance, steps, streams/counter-streams, urban-industrial attraction | Nineteenth-century historical propositions
- Lee | Origin/destination factors + obstacles + personal selectivity | Framework, not weighted causal prediction
- Stouffer | Acceptable nearer opportunities can intercept flows | Opportunity is hard to measure
- Gravity/Zipf | Flow rises with mass and falls with distance/cost | Calibrate; policy/network residuals
- Harris-Todaro | Expected urban return, not observed wage alone | Imperfect information and non-wage motives
- Lewis | Labour transfer + reinvestment → turning point | Informality, seasonality, gender and institutions
- NELM | Household risk, credit, insurance and remittance strategy | Household conflict and poorest may be trapped
- World-systems | Uneven historical incorporation creates corridors | Can understate agency
- Dual labour market | Destination structurally demands precarious labour | Stronger for destination demand
- Network | Earlier migrants lower later costs | Continuation more than initiation
- Cumulative causation | Migration changes conditions to encourage more migration | Path is not irreversible
- Zelinsky | Mobility forms change with demographic/urban transition | Non-deterministic, Western historical origin
- **Best combination:** structural inequality creates the corridor; destination demand opens jobs; household strategy selects participation; networks select route; personal factors select the mover.

THEORY MATRIX - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

THEORY MATRIX - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

70. Final register notes 5/10 - India dated evidence

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

INDIA DATED EVIDENCE - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Source | High-yield fact | Limit
- Census 2011 D-03 | 455.8m all-duration migrants by last residence; about 37.6% of 2011 population | Dated stock, not 2026 flow
- Census 2011 internal | 449.9m last residence within India; about 87.9% within State | Broad all-duration concept
- Census 2011 streams | Rural-rural 213.8m, largest identifiable matrix stream | Dated
- Census 2011 gender | Marriage about 66.5% of female migrants | Reason code can conceal work
- PLFS 2020-21 | Migration rate 28.9%; rural 26.5%; urban 34.9% | Survey period July 2020-June 2021

- PLFS origin | Same State 87.5%; another State 11.8%; other country 0.7% | Distribution, not annual flow
- PLFS gender | Marriage 86.8% of female migrants | Dated primary reason
- PLFS temporary visitors | 0.7% of population under special definition | Pandemic-affected module
- Intra-State predominance is compatible with economically important inter-State labour corridors.
- Public debate over-focuses on male rural-urban labour migration; rural-rural, marriage, urban-urban and circular streams matter.
- Source-safe corridors: eastern/central/agrarian/drought-prone origins → Delhi NCR, western industrial belts, Punjab-Haryana, southern urban/service markets; do not invent current ranking.

INDIA DATED EVIDENCE - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

INDIA DATED EVIDENCE - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

71. Final register notes 6/10 - labour, gender, urban and rural consequences

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

LABOUR, GENDER, URBAN AND RURAL CONSEQUENCES - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Labour and circularity
- Sectors: construction, industry, agriculture, brick kilns, mines, transport, domestic work, hospitality and informal services.
- Risks: recruiter advance, deductions, wage delay, hazardous work, employer-linked housing, childcare and documentation gaps.
- Circularity can be a rational multi-local strategy, not incomplete settlement.
- Gender
- Marriage reason dominates official female migration coding.
- Track subsequent work, unpaid family labour, care, control over remittances, safety and agency.
- Independent education/work migration can expand capabilities; class and occupation condition freedom.
- Urbanisation
- Urban growth = natural increase + net migration + reclassification/boundary change.
- Migrants add labour, entrepreneurship and diversity.
- Housing informality and congestion often show planning/finance exclusion, not migrant "burden."
- Intermediate towns are Stouffer-style intervening opportunities.
- Rural origin
- Gains: remittances, reduced land pressure, wage rise, skills and ideas.
- Costs: selective loss, care burden, seasonal labour scarcity, inequality and remittance dependence.
- Feminisation of agriculture does not automatically mean land rights or decision power.

LABOUR, GENDER, URBAN AND RURAL CONSEQUENCES - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

LABOUR, GENDER, URBAN AND RURAL CONSEQUENCES - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**72. Final register notes 7/10 - international migration and remittances**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**INTERNATIONAL MIGRATION AND REMITTANCES - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC**

- Streams: Gulf contract labour, high-skilled professionals, students, family reunion, seafarers, irregular migration and return.
- UN DESA/RBI: about 18.5m international migrants originating from India in 2024.
- MEA January 2026: PIO + NRI country table; examples—UAE NRIs 4,326,248; Saudi Arabia NRIs 2,747,551.
- **Do not call MEA NRI figures worker counts.**
- eMigrate: covered ECR/employment administration, recruiting-agent verification and grievances; not all departures.
- Remittance firewall
- RBI 2023-24 inward remittances: US\$118.7bn under its framework.
- World Bank 2025 personal remittances received: US\$150.7bn current US dollars.
- RBI source shares: US 27.7%, UAE 19.2%, GCC combined 38% in 2023-24 survey.
- Cost of sending US\$200 to India: 4.9% in 2023; digital cost 4.0% in Q2 2024.
- Difference between RBI and World Bank is not an error without metadata comparison.
- Remittances can reduce poverty but do not prove productive transformation.

INTERNATIONAL MIGRATION AND REMITTANCES - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

INTERNATIONAL MIGRATION AND REMITTANCES - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**73. Final register notes 8/10 - displacement, development and climate**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**DISPLACEMENT, DEVELOPMENT AND CLIMATE - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC**

- Forced-displacement tree
- Conflict/persecution + international border + applicable grounds → refugee/asylum route.
- Conflict/violence/disaster + remains within country → IDP.
- Statelessness concerns nationality, not movement alone.

- End-2025 UNHCR: 41.6m refugees, about 9m asylum-seekers, 68.6m IDPs.
- Development displacement
- Dams, mines, corridors, urban projects and conservation can cause physical, economic and cultural loss.
- Compensation is not rehabilitation.
- Monitor land/tenure, livelihood, commons, services, culture, networks and grievances.
- RFCTLARR Act 2013 is relevant; legal acquisition does not prove successful resettlement.
- Climate mobility
- Sudden: evacuation, temporary displacement, repeated relocation.
- Slow: salinisation, erosion, water stress, desertification, sea-level rise and livelihood change.
- Migration can be adaptation or adaptation failure.
- Trapped populations lack capability to move; immobility can also be chosen.
- Attribution is multi-causal; never invent a national climate-migrant count.

DISPLACEMENT, DEVELOPMENT AND CLIMATE - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

DISPLACEMENT, DEVELOPMENT AND CLIMATE - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

74. Final register notes 9/10 - 2026 governance dashboard

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

2026 GOVERNANCE DASHBOARD - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- **Census 2027:** migration information planned in Phase II; no result.
- **PLFS July 2026 CWS:** LFPR 55.4%, WPR 52.5%, UR 5.1% for 15+; labour context only.
- **e-Shram:** 31.48 crore registered unorganised workers as on 26 January 2026; not migrant count.
- **Labour Codes:** effective 21 November 2025; official releases state expanded self-migrated/contractor migrant coverage, travel allowance and portability.
- **ONORC:** all 36 States/UTs; around 80 crore NFSA beneficiaries; latest retrieved cumulative transaction data are year-end 2024, not 2026 impact.
- **Policy ladder:** registration → accurate category → eligibility → portability → successful use → outcome.
- Portable basics: food, health, school, childcare, social security and grievances.
- Destination infrastructure: rental housing, hostels, water, sanitation, transport and health.
- Data: interoperability with consent/purpose limitation; do not turn mobility data into surveillance.
- International: ethical recruitment, contracts, skill recognition, consular protection and social-security cooperation.

2026 GOVERNANCE DASHBOARD - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Rapid-revision answer route: define → date evidence → explain at the correct level → qualify → govern.

2026 GOVERNANCE DASHBOARD - NEXT REVISION LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**75. Final register notes 10/10 - traps, PYQ routes and verdict**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND VERDICT - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC**

- Ten traps
- 1. Census 2011 share presented as current 2026 fact.
- 2. Census 2027 schedule presented as migration result.
- 3. Survey rate presented as annual flow.
- 4. e-Shram registration presented as migrant headcount.
- 5. ONORC coverage presented as universal successful use.
- 6. MEA diaspora presented as UN migrant stock.
- 7. Migrant and refugee used interchangeably.
- 8. All urban growth attributed to migration.
- 9. Marriage coding treated as proof of no female work.
- 10. Every disaster mover called a climate refugee.
- PYQ routes
- **Large-city attraction:** expected income + diversified opportunity + agglomeration + network → Stouffer qualification → intermediate towns.
- **Skilled women's urban migration:** autonomy + income + networks → family negotiation/digital surveillance → class, safety and care qualification.
- **Indentured labour:** post-emancipation labour demand + colonial vulnerability/recruitment → transformed cultural preservation.
- **Diaspora:** economic networks + political voice → diversity/autonomy qualification.
- **Constitutional Prelims:** inter-State quarantine is Union List; migration question is a Polity cross-link.
- Final verdict
- Migration is neither a pathology to suppress nor an automatic development solution. It is a selective, multi-level response to spatially unequal opportunity, household risk, labour demand, social networks, conflict and environmental change. India's policy objective should be **freedom with safety, productivity with rights, portability with privacy, and source-region capability without coercive immobility.**